



Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra | Fold8

Galaxy AI ✨

EMI starting ₹ 2025/month*

Model Name	Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra	Galaxy Z Fold8
Retail price	₹ 199999	₹ 179999
Exchange value of old device~ (Max)	₹ 90000	₹ 90000
Exchange bonus^ 	₹ 4000	₹ 4000
Instant cashback#	₹ 5000	₹ 5000
Net effective price (1 unit)	₹ 100999	₹ 80999
Per month EMI starting	₹ 2525**	₹ 2025*

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Image simulated. Samsung account login may be required for certain AI features. Actual UX/UI may differ. Samsung promotes responsible use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) features. T&C apply. *EMI amount ₹ 2025 is computed on 40 months No Cost EMI including 10 months down payment at the price of ₹ 80999 for 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold8 12|256GB, inclusive of Exchange Value of old device, Exchange bonus with EMI at ₹ 4000 and Instant discount at ₹ 5000. EMI rounded off to nearest rupee for ease of reference. Eligibility for EMI at the sole discretion of the financiers including those listed on Samsung Finance+ (Financier T&C applies). Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same. **EMI amount ₹ 2525 is computed on 40 months No Cost EMI including 10 months down payment at the price of ₹ 100999 for 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra 12|256GB, inclusive of Exchange Value of old device, Exchange bonus with EMI at ₹ 4000 and Instant cashback at ₹ 5000. EMI rounded off to nearest rupee for ease of reference. Eligibility for EMI at the sole discretion of the financiers including those listed on Samsung Finance+ (Financier T&C applies). Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same. *Approximate value on exchange of 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold7 12|256 GB. Exchange value varies basis model & condition of old device. Exchange at the sole discretion of dealer. *Customers of Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra 12|256GB & Galaxy Z Fold8 12|256GB are eligible for benefits of maximum exchange bonus of ₹ 8000. Customers availing any NBFC EMI will be eligible to get upto ₹ 4000 exchange bonus. Exchange Bonus as per Samsung Upgrade program, provided by brand/dealer at their sole discretion upon exchange of select devices. *Limited Period Offer and subject to availability of stocks. Aforesaid calculations are for illustrative purposes, final price at the sole discretion of retailer.

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Per month EMI starting*	₹ 1000



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artistry, stories, and rich cultural heritage.
*A celebration of Madurai's divine legacy,
beautifully brought to life.*

**The
Goddess's
Realm**

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The Goddess's Realm



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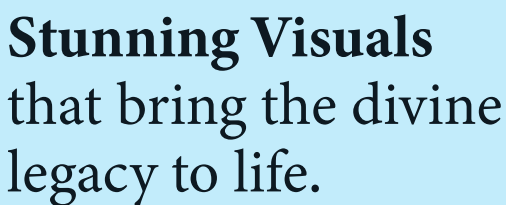
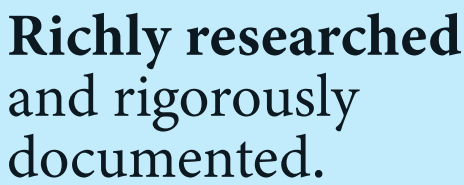


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Clashes, canvassing on vehicles mark final day of DUSU poll campaigning

Students report clash between ABVP and ASAP members; two Satyawati College students injured in altercation; action will be taken if the culprits are found to be students, says Proctor; policemen, patrolling vehicles deployed outside campuses

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Sporadic clashes between individuals and student groups, heightened police deployment and disruption to classes and commuting marked the final days as campaigning for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections ended on Wednesday.

Students reported a scuffle outside Motilal Nehru College on Tuesday evening between representatives of the RSS-affiliated student outfit ABVP and the Aam Aadmi Party's student wing AAP.

"Fifty to 60 members from the ABVP walked into the campus even though the rules do not allow more than five students to enter. The students attacked each other and police did not even stop them while they were fighting in front of them," a student said, preferring



Students associated with the ABVP campaigning for their candidates at Delhi University on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

anonymity.

A student associated with the ABVP was injured during a confrontation between the outfit and workers of the Congress, IYC and NSUI outside the university's Law Centre-I (LC-I) on Wednesday, ABVP Delhi State secretary Sarthak Sharma alleged.

He said the incident was an attempt to intimidate its workers and disrupt the campus environment and demanded action against

those responsible.

On Tuesday, an altercation between two Satyawati College students during election campaigning left both injured and two vehicles damaged near Wazirpur village in north-west Delhi. The police said 19-year-olds Ansh and Bhavishya Chaudhary were taken to Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital for treatment.

The Delhi police clarified that claims of firing during the clash were

"completely false and factually incorrect" after receiving a PCR call reporting an assault and firing following the altercation. Further investigation is under way.

'Action will be taken'

DU Proctor Manoj Kumar Singh said, "Some clashes between groups have come to my notice. So far, it appears the clashes have involved supporters from outside the college. However, if we receive a complaint, we will examine the CCTV footage and conduct an inquiry, and action will be taken if the culprits are found to be students."

Meanwhile, high-pitched campaigning continued on campus on the final day, with student organisations distributing pamphlets and canvassing despite stringent curbs on campaign material, vehicles and loudspeakers.

Bharat Dahiya, a student of Hindu College,

said, "Use of printed posters or pamphlets is not allowed as per the guidelines, but what they do is they get them printed and circulate, paste and throw them in the campus area."

Another student pointed out that candidates are seen campaigning with 10-12 vehicles.

For students not involved in campaigning, however, the election period increasingly meant navigating busy roads, disrupted classes and large groups of campaigners moving through campuses. "Classes are cut off or don't happen and you can't really study because of the elections," a student said.

Security arrangements across campuses were stepped up on the final day of campaigning, with detention vehicles, patrol vehicles and motorcycles deployed and paramilitary personnel brought in.

(With inputs from Anagha Maria)

GTB Hospital to get ₹244.87-cr. worth super-speciality, trauma block by 2028, says CM Gupta

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Cabinet has approved the construction of a 250-bed super-speciality and trauma block at Guru Teg Bahadur (GTB) Hospital in Dilshad Garden under the Centre's Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSY), the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) stated in an official release on Wednesday.

The decision was taken at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday.

The new block, to be built within the hospital campus, is estimated to cost ₹244.87 crore and is expected to be completed by 2028, the release added.

Heavy patient load

"GTB Hospital is the only major government hospital in east Delhi and continues to face a heavy patient load. Almost all its beds remain occupied. In view of this, there was a need to



CM Rekha Gupta said the new block will boost east Delhi's emergency care capacity. ANI

the lines of All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS).

New block

Spread over 22,550 square metres, the new seven-storied facility will comprise a basement, ground floor, and six upper floors. It will have 250 beds, 48 special

ist OPD rooms and nine modern operation theatres.

The basement will house a blood bank and laboratory, the CMO stated. The CM said that the new block will bring together all essential facilities, from 24x7 emergency care and diagnostics to intensive care and surgery.

"This will expand east Delhi's capacity to treat critical accident and emergency cases," she added.

The latest development follows the Delhi government's decision in March this year to merge the GTB Hospital, the Delhi State Cancer Institute, and the Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital into an autonomous institution on

expand modern trauma facilities for accident victims and critical emergency cases," Ms. Gupta said.

"The Delhi government aims to expand the capacity of government hospitals while ensuring that people receive better and timely medical care when they need it," she added.

The latest development follows the Delhi government's decision in March this year to merge the GTB Hospital, the Delhi State Cancer Institute, and the Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital into an autonomous institution on

Students, daily wagers suffer as DTC strike enters Day 2; DMRC steps up

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Several students and daily wage earners were left stranded for the second consecutive day as Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus drivers continued their strike demanding higher wages and med-

ical benefits.

The drivers, mostly operating new electric buses, said they will continue to protest on Thursday.

Transport Minister Pan- kaj Singh assured the drivers of resolving their issues and appealed them to call off the strike.

To ease the crisis, the

Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) increased metro services, running 20 extra trips using eight additional trains across various routes. The increased metro frequencies will continue on Thursday from 8 a.m. to 11 p.m. to manage the surge, the DMRC stated.

Satya Niketan building collapse not ordinary mishap: HC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday said the collapse of a multi-storey building housing a paying guest (PG) accommodation in Satya Niketan on September 6, which resulted in the death of seven persons including students, was not an "ordinary

mishap".

A Bench of Chief Justice D.K. Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia orally remarked, "Four students lost their lives in the mishap.... It's not an ordinary incident of any mishap. These four students had come to the Capital with a lot of hopes and dreams, coming from small towns. All of that was shattered by

such callous and criminal conduct on the part of (certain persons)."

The court was hearing a petition by Aakarshak Dan- veer Rathi seeking an independent probe into the matter, inspection of all PGs as well as compensation and a rehabilitation scheme for victims and their families. Additional Solicitor General Chetan

Sharma said several steps have been taken by the authorities after the incident, including proactive mapping and earmarking of land and other facilities for students.

'Not new phenomenon'

The Bench, however, responded that the issue of lack of hostel facilities was not a "new phenomenon".

"Students are flocking to Delhi for higher education, and this is not a new phenomenon. It has been happening for the last 20-25 years in the hope that they will build their career. See what has happened," the Bench remarked.

The court said the petition would be heard along with another pending petition on September 25.

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e-tender Invitation for Bids No: 11/2026-2027 Dated: 11.09.2026

Name of Work	Approximate value of work in Lakhs (2025-2026)
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1) For Tender document, visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>
2) Date and Time for downloading and submission the tender documents : **06.10.2026 from 12.00 Noon to 04.11.2026 upto 06.00 P.M**
3) Date and time of opening of the e-tender : **06.11.2026 at 11.15 A.M**
4) Detailed Tender Notice available in the website www.tnphc.com & www.tnphc.com

Superintending Engineer,
South Circle, TNPHC Ltd

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For eligibility criteria, terms and conditions and complete details, please log on to the Company website : www.dtl.gov.in under the head "Careers".

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar
Division, 2nd Floor, BMP Complex, Dhanvantri Road,
Bengaluru-560009

No.:EE/GNR/Tend/KPPP/014/2026-27 Date:16.09.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT)
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)
The Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division, BCCC invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered with CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES or any State Government Organisations for the works detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains & other Developmental Works in ward No 122,125 & 127. Amount put to Tender : Rs. 489.34 Lakhs. EMD: Rs. 7,34,000/- (1 lakh through e payment Remaining in BG/FDR)

1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> 2) Last Date for submission of tender: **25.09.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** 3) Opening of technical bid: **28.09.2026 at 12.30 Hrs.** 4) Opening of Financial Bid: **Will be intimated through KPP Portal.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
Gandhinagar Division.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No.	Material Description	Due date
262713 003891	Procurement of Fuel Oil for Unit-I & II	24.09.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites : www.tnpl.com / <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgepapp>

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INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
The Executive Engineer, B&R Division, HPPWD Sangrah, District Sirmaur, H.P. on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the **percentage rates bids**, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class of Contractors registered with HPPWD for the works detailed in the table.

Sr. No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (₹)	Starting Date for Downloading Bid	Earnest Money (₹)	Deadline for Submission of Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6
1.	Construction of balance work of 165.00 mtr Span Double lane Bridge on Nahan Dadahu Haripurhar Road at RD 35/690, (SH- C/O of approach road along with M/T) Under CRF (Job No. CRF-HP-2018-19-155)	56082510/-	16.09.2026	1324000/-	01.10.2026

Bidders are advised to submit their bids as per instructions issued by the Engineer-in-Chief, HPPWD Shimla vide his office letter No. PW/CTR/32-20/Genl. Inst. CPWD/2020-19111-210 dated 25.10.2021 and even file letter No. 37996-38095 dated 13.03.2023 in compliance of the Principal Secretary (PW) to the Government of Himachal Pradesh guidelines dated 07.10.2021 in continuation to notification issued by the Additional Chief Secretary (PW) to the Govt. of HP vide notification No. PBW(B/A)(3)/2020 dated 22.7.2020. Tenders are conveyed on percentage rates as per directions of the Chief Engineer (SZ), HPPWD Shimla conveyed vide letter No. PW-CTR-29-Misc/2023-36299-329 dated 16.02.2023. Amendment as per the Engineer-in-Chief letter No. PW-CTR-32-20/Tender Document/256-15061-85 dated 17.07.2026 will be applicable.
The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer,
HPPWD (B & R) Division Sangrah,
Tel/Fax: 01702-248207
E-mail: ee-san-hp@nic.in
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh
him suchana avam jan sampark

HP / 3426/26-27

THE HINDU
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Delhi Palam Today 34°C The weather will be warm. Spell of light rain and thundershower with gusty winds may occur. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow 33°C The weather will be warm. Spell of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower to occur. Night will be comfortable.

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E-tender Specification No. CCP-I/27/2026-2027 Cluster-A, B & C invited by this office for Implementation of Standalone Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) of 100MW/250MMWh capacity at various Locations / Substations of UPCL under Capacity Charged Based Competitive Bidding Mechanism, are hereby extended due to unavoidable reasons. The e-tender can be purchased and submitted upto 17:00hrs of **22.9.2026**. Part-I of the e-tender shall be opened on **23.9.2026** at 11:30hrs onwards.
Other terms & conditions will remain same as per original tender notice. For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in.
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Executive Engineer, Pb. W/S & Sew., Divn. Ropar on the behalf of Chief Executive Officer, Pb. W/S and Sew. Board Chandigarh invites online bids for the following works:-

Sr. No.	Items	App. Cost.	Cost of Document	Earnest Money	Period of Completion
1	Providing, Laying, of Sewer Construction of IPS MPS. Laying of Rising Main and Construction of 5.5 MLD STP Plant Cum 17 KLD FSTP Based on any Suitable Sustainable & Proven Biological Technology Works Including O&M of Sixty Months Only for STP & FSTP and all other works Contingent There to at Gharuan Distt SAS Nagar (SBM 2.0 Scheme)	As per DNIT	Rs. 1000/- + As admissible	2% DNIT Cost.	As per DNIT

Closing date & Time → 12.10.2026 upto 3.00 P.M.
Opening date & Time → 13.10.2026 upto 3.00 P.M.
Prebid Meeting Date → 25.09.2026 at 09.00 A.M.
For detailed Log onto <https://proc.punjab.gov.in>.
Note: Any Corrigendum (s), to the Tender/RFP Notice shall be published on the above website only.

Executive Engineer,
Pb. W/S & Sew. Divn.,
Ropar.

1796/12/2026-27/15240

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Open E-tender on single packet system through E-Tender Notice No: M/DSL/IZN/TC/OT/128 is invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRS, Loco Shed, N.E.Railway, Iztanagar for and on behalf of President of India for the following work :-
Name of work: Changing of brake blocks of brake hanger and pull rod hole adjustment of Electric and Diesel Locomotives at Loco shed, Izzatanagar. Estimated Value of work(Rs): ₹ 30,50,615.25 (Incl. all taxes), Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs): ₹ 61,000/- Cost of Tender Document -Rs. 0.00 (Zero), Period of work-03 Years, Total Quantity -16425 Nos. (Brake Block). Date and time for closing of E-tender: 07.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
Tenderer may submit their E-tenders online upto 15:00 hrs on 07.10.2026. Please go to the Indian railway website www.ireps.gov.in to see the complete details and upload/submit the E-tender.
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PUBLIC NOTICE
Under instructions from and on behalf of my client, Mrs. Divya Xavier Pilkington, D/O Late Shri Maharajkumar Virendrasinh Jhala, W/o Shri Michael Xavier Pilkington, notice is hereby given that the original Registered Power of Attorney dated 28.11.2019, executed by Sh. Devraj Virendrasinh Jhala, S/o Late Shri Maharajkumar Virendrasinh Jhala, in favour of Mrs. Shivangini Kumari Jhala, and registered as Document No. 2616, in the office of the Sub-Registrar, S.R.O. Dhrangadhra, Gujarat, on 28.11.2019, has been lost/misplaced and could not be traced despite diligent search. A Lost Article Report bearing LR No. 629058/2026, dated 14.09.2026, has been lodged at Police Station North Avenue-e-Police Station, New Delhi, by my client in respect of the said loss. Any person(s) finding the said document or having any claim, objection, or information with respect to the same is/are requested to intimate the undersigned at the address given below within 20 (Twenty) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no such claim or objection exists, and no claim by any third party shall be entertained thereafter.
RAMIT K. LALIT (ADVOCATE)
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M NO-NDE

Seven Keralam wards face
bypolls as civic officials
leave for more secure jobs

G. Ragesh
KOCHI

The lure of a permanent job and a better life is hard to resist, at least for a few civic representatives in Keralam who quit their posts, paving the way for bypolls in the wards they represented.

Of the 38 local body wards going to polls on September 28, seven gram panchayat wards have fallen vacant after elected representatives resigned after securing jobs.

While two of them have travelled abroad, three have landed part-time government jobs. One member quit following her appointment as an anganwadi supervisor and another after being appointed to a Minister's staff.

Choosing between the responsibilities entrusted to them by the electorate and the need for financial security has not been an easy task, some of them say. "I had applied for a visa in 2024. I accepted the offer to contest the election as the visa got delayed. I'm sad that I had to leave the responsibilities entrusted upon me," said Raji

Many elected representatives find it difficult to run their day-to-day affairs with the honorarium they get, said former Kochi mayor M. Anilkumar

Rajeev, who quit as the member of the Puliyanam South ward of Parakkada-
vu gram panchayat.

Sindu Sanjayan of the Congress quit as the member representing Blockpadi ward of Ranni gram panchayat in Pathanamthitta district after securing a part-time job. "I had always wanted to find a job. My party leadership supported my decision," she said.

Former Kochi mayor M. Anilkumar, also the co-chair of the Urban Policy Commission, said the low payment had been making the job of an elected local body representative unattractive to many. "Even corporation councillors have been quitting after securing jobs as many elected representatives find it difficult to run their day-to-day affairs with the honorarium they get," he said.

Dadasaheb Phalke honour for
Kannada film artist Anant Nag

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a big honour for Kannada cinema, veteran actor Anant Nag became the second artist from the State to win the Dadasaheb Phalke Award on Wednesday. The recognition comes a year after the actor was given the Padma Bhushan.

After Dr. Rajkumar received the honour in 1995, no Kannada actor had bagged the country's highest award in the field of cinema.

Mr. Nag, who debuted with the 1973 Kannada film *Sankalpa*, has acted in more than 300 movies for over five decades in both mainstream and parallel cinema, with more than 250 of his performances being in Kannada.

The actor, born Anant Nagarkatte in 1948 in Uttara Kannada district, began his acting stint with Kannada, Marathi, Hindi and Konkani plays, and has a rich background in theatre shaped largely in Mumbai.

Mr. Nag is the recipient of five Karnataka State Awards, including the Lifetime Achievement honour.

He will receive the Phalke award at the 72nd



The recognition comes a year after Anant Nag was given the Padma Bhushan.

National Film Awards Ceremony on September 22 in Kevadia, Gujarat.

'Great feeling'
"It's a great feeling to receive this honour. In a way, I feel the Padma Bhushan was a rehearsal for this big award, with all the excitement and anticipation that came with it. I dedicate this award to Kannadigas and Karnataka," the actor told presspersons in Bengaluru.

A statement from the Press Information Bureau read, "On the recommendation of the Dadasaheb Phalke Award Selection Committee, the Government of India is pleased to announce that the actor

will be conferred the prestigious Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024 for his contribution to Indian cinema and an illustrious cinematic journey that has inspired generations."

Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated the actor for "infusing unparalleled performance and vitality in every role he played." Mr. Modi took to social media, and said, "Over the past several decades, his natural acting, remarkable versatility, and exceptional artistic talent have left an indelible mark on Indian cinema, particularly in the Kannada film industry."

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar also commended Mr. Nag's cinematic journey and the Phalke award. In a post on X, the Chief Minister said, "Heartfelt congratulations to Shri Anant Nag. His artistic journey will forever inspire future generations."

Though cinematographer V.K. Murthy, from Karnataka, received the award in 2008, it recognised his work in Hindi cinema. Consequently, Mr. Nag's win marks only the second time Kannada cinema has been honoured.

'Never met or known Disha Salian'

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray on Wednesday denied any link with the death of late

actor Sushant Singh Rajput's ex-manager Disha Salian, two days after the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) named him in the FIR.

"I have never met or

known Disha Salian," he said adding that "this is a deliberate, evidence-free attempt to character assassinate" by a few individuals with clear political and personal motives.

CJP to launch 'Adivasi School Thik Karo' drive

Press Trust of India
NAGPUR

Alleging that tribal schools in India have been facing government apathy for the last 80 years, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Wednesday announced the launch 'Adivasi School Thik Karo'

campaign from Gadchiroli in the State from September 17.

Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Dipke said the campaign is aimed at drawing the government's attention towards the problems and discrimination faced by tribal students.

He said, "Schools in tri-

bal regions across India have been neglected by all governments. Therefore, we are starting the campaign from Thursday in Gadchiroli district of Maharashtra."

Gadchiroli is a tribal-dominated district in eastern Maharashtra's Vidarbha region.

INSTITUTE FOR SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC CHANGE
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INBRIEF



AISA seeks FIR over ‘threats’ to national president Neha Bora

The All India Students’ Association (AISA) has approached the Director General of Police, Uttar Pradesh, seeking the registration of an FIR over alleged death threats issued to its national president Neha Bora, who is travelling across the State as part of the organisation’s ‘GenZ Rising’ campaign. In a complaint on Tuesday, AISA general secretary Prasenjeet Kumar stated that several messages containing “explicit threats of violence” against Ms. Bora, along with abusive and objectionable messages, had been received on one of the organisation’s official contact numbers.

CISE, IIT-K sign MoUs to boost cybersecurity, anti-drone tech

The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has signed two MoUs with the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Kanpur to strengthen its capabilities in cybersecurity and anti-drone technology to secure critical and strategic infrastructure. The agreements, signed on Tuesday provide for a six-week cybersecurity training programme through C3iHub, a cybersecurity technology innovation hub at IIT Kanpur, and the establishment and development of a centre of excellence in anti-drone technology at the paramilitary force’s regional training centre in Rajasthan’s Behror town.

Nakkeeran journalist held for defamatory video against YouTuber

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Adambakkam police on Wednesday arrested a 58-year-old journalist, Damodharan Prakash, of *Nakkeeran*, on charges of posting a defamatory video on social media against a 38-year-old YouTuber. In a press release, the police stated that Mr. Prakash had posted a “derogatory and defamatory” video in January this year against an Adambakkam-based woman working for a YouTube channel. Based on the complaint filed by the woman, the Adambakkam police filed a case under various sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, the Information Technology Act and the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act, said the police.

‘No family will be without support’: Chouhan surveys Bihar’s flood-affected areas

50 lakh people have been affected, says Union Minister after visiting Hajipur, Bhagalpur and other areas; Central team to review situation, send report based on which aid will be disbursed, he adds

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Wednesday visited the flood-hit areas in several districts of Bihar.

Accompanied by Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, Bihar Ministers and teams from the Central and State governments, Mr. Chouhan travelled on boats and tractors to reach the affected areas of Hajipur, Vaishali, Munger and Bhagalpur, and conducted an aerial survey to assess the extent of damage and losses suffered by farmers.

He also spoke to a few flood victims.

Speaking to mediapersons after his visit, Mr. Chouhan said the Central government “stands like a rock” with the people of Bihar, and all possible financial and infrastructural assistance would be provided for their safe evacuation. The Central



Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan with CM Samrat Choudhary during a visit to Hajipur on Wednesday. PTI

government is “fully sensitive and proactive” regarding the devastating floods caused by the record rise in the levels of the Ganga and other rivers across Bihar, he added.

The Union Minister began by visiting the worst-affected villages of Terasia and Saprapur in Hajipur.

He inspected submerged residential areas and farmlands while travelling on motorboats and traditional boats. He also assessed the situation from a tractor in several hard-to-reach locations.

“Approximately 50 lakh people have been directly affected by this calamity. People have been forced to leave their homes,” said Mr. Chouhan.

‘Deeply distressing’

He added, “Houses have sustained damage, and livestock has been lost. Farmers’ hard-earned labour being submerged in water is deeply distressing. The government is fully committed to safeguarding their hard work and livelihoods.” “Officials from the Agri-

culture and Rural Development Departments are assessing the situation. Shortly, a detailed inter-ministerial central team will be dispatched to Bihar,” said the Union Minister.

He added that the team will conduct a comprehensive assessment of the damage across various districts, with specific assessments of crops, roads, bridges, houses and livestock, following which the Centre will release adequate financial and material assistance, in accordance with the State government’s proposal.

“I assure the people of Bihar on behalf of the Central government and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, that while the crisis is immense, our resolve and commitment to serve are even greater. We stand with the State government to help it navigate this crisis. No affected family will be left without support,” said Mr. Chouhan. He later held a review meeting at the Chief Minister’s residence in Patna.

Police search places linked to ex-DMK Minister over ‘scam’

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI/CHENNAI

A team from the Central Crime Branch of Chennai City Police conducted simultaneous searches at four locations in Tiruchi and Chennai linked to former DMK Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, including his residence in Tiruchi, on Wednesday in connection with a case registered against him under the Prevention of Corruption Act over an alleged multi-crore fraud involving private schools. The ‘fraud’ was allegedly perpetrated when he was the School Education Minister during the previous DMK regime.

The Central Crime Branch had previously arrested B.T. Arasakumar, 59, of Saligramam in Chennai in June this year and two more persons in connection with the same case.

Act of vendetta: Stalin

DMK president and former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin termed the police searches “an act of political vendetta” and a diversionary tactic of the TVK-led government. He said the DMK would legally fight against it and that the government will soon real-



Police outside ex-Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi’s house on Wednesday. R. VENGADESH

ise that false allegations will not stand before the law either.

Mr. Poyyamozhi said the DMK was a 77-year-old party and would not be cowed down by searches by enforcement agencies. Speaking to journalists after the completion of the over eight-hour-long search operation at his Tiruchi residence, he termed the searches as “political vendetta” after his statements on defeating the TVK in the upcoming Dharapuram bypoll. Former DMK Minister and the party’s principal secretary K.N. Nehru accused the TVK of deliberately “targeting” and intimidating those in the DMK who had “performed well” on the ground.

Allahabad HC frees man confined after conversion, relationship with Muslim woman, cites Articles 21, 25

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday set at liberty a 31-year-old man, Ayush Malik, who had accused his father of illegally confining him after he converted to Islam and entered into a relationship with a Muslim woman, Chandni Qureshi.

Based on Mr. Ayush’s submission that he had voluntarily embraced Islam in 2014 and accepted Ms. Qureshi as his partner, the court observed that the choice of a person with whom an adult wishes to establish a matrimonial relationship forms part of the right to life and personal liberty under Article 21 of the Constitution.

It added that such choices cannot be curtailed merely because they are contrary to the wishes of family members.

Following Mr. Ayush’s conversion from Hinduism to Islam, the police in Shamli district registered a case under the Uttar Pradesh Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion Act, 2021 against Ms. Qureshi and her father.

The two were subsequently arrested in connection with the case and spent months in jail before being granted bail by a Shamli court on July 24.

Capable of decisions

A single-judge Bench of Justice Sandeep Jain, which was hearing a *habeas corpus* petition, said it was apparent from Mr. Ayush’s statements that he had attained majority and was capable of taking decisions concerning his life.

In his plea, Mohd. Sultan, claiming to be Mr. Ayush’s friend, alleged that his friend had voluntarily embraced Islam without

coercion, undue influence or inducement and subsequently decided to marry Ms. Qureshi. The plea also claimed Mr. Ayush’s father, Devraj Singh Malik, had opposed the relationship.

During his interaction with the Bench on Wednesday, Mr. Ayush said he had been subjected to threats and confined illegally by his father since June 4. Mr. Devraj disputed the allegations and told the court that his son had been influenced by “certain individuals”.

After hearing both sides, the court said nothing had been brought on record to persuade it to disbelieve Mr. Ayush’s statement.

“Freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise and propagate religion are guaranteed under Article 25 of the Constitution,” the court stated in its order.

Man shoots dead teacher in Bijnor for ‘encouraging love jihad’

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

A 40-year-old primary school teacher, Naushad, was shot dead outside his school in Bijnor on Tuesday by a man who later surrendered and told the police that he suspected the teacher of “encouraging love jihad”, an officer said on Wednesday, adding that Mr. Rathni was arrested after he surrendered. ‘Love jihad’ is a term coined by right-wing outfits for inter-faith couples.

Naushad was preparing to return home after classes ended at Saupuri Primary School when Mr. Rathni opened fire at him. Police said they are probing the accused’s statement and other aspects of the case.

Bijnor SP K.K. Bishnoi said the reason for the murder had “not yet been established”.

Maharashtra farmers hold protests, seek drought aid; doing everything possible, won’t let them suffer: CM

Snehal Mutha
MUMBAI

A pause in the monsoon has led to a drought-like situation in parts of Maharashtra’s Marathwada and Vidarbha regions. At least 83 talukas in 19 districts have recorded a rain break of more than 20 days, with some areas going without rain for over 40 days, according to the State Agriculture Department.

On Wednesday, farmers demanded that the Maharashtra government officially declare a drought in the affected districts, provide compensation and implement relief measures.

The government has ordered a ground-level assessment from October 5 to assess the extent of damage and provide relief to affected farmers.

Farmers in Washim and Beed districts took to the roads on Wednesday. In



As many as 83 talukas in 19 districts have recorded rain breaks of more than 20 days, as per the State Agriculture Dept. FILE PHOTO

Washim, the symbolic protests were led by NCP (SP) leader Rohit Pawar.

“Farmers have lost their crop and are facing heavy losses. Labourers are similarly affected,” he said. Mr. Pawar sought compensation of ₹50,000 per hectare to farmers’ families and ₹25,000 for the families of farm labourers.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said, “We will not let farmers suffer. We will help them with everything

we have. I have instructed the officials concerned to prepare a framework to help those affected.”

Criticism from Oppn.

The Opposition has criticised the government for “wasting time” on surveys.

Senior Congress leader Vijay Wadettiwar said, “The kharif crop has fallen into crisis. Farmers are facing losses in soyabean, paddy and other crops due to deficient rain.”

Assam’s Lok Sabha bypoll could define contours of Opposition politics in the State

NEWS ANALYSIS

Abdus Salam

The line-up for the Nagaon parliamentary seat byelection on October 6 is complete with the All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF) nominating its chief, Badruddin Ajmal, as its candidate on Tuesday. His entry makes it a four-way contest, with former legislator Sibamoni Bora of the Congress, former bureaucrat Devasish Sharma of the BJP and Congress, since the former’s crushing sweep in the April Assembly election with 102 out of 126 seats for the National Democratic Alliance. The AIUDF’s last-



The Assam Congress, led by MP Gaurav Gogoi, has broken ties recently with the Rajior Dal of Akhil Gogoi (left). FILE PHOTO

minute candidate switch from former student leader Rejaul Karim Sarkar to its founder is a bold gambit that could radically alter Opposition politics in a foreseeable future where the ruling party holds near-absolute sway.

Even as the upper regions of Assam were still reeling from the impact of sudden floods in July, the State’s broader Opposition unity fractured on September 3 when the Congress formally severed ties with Akhil Gogoi’s Rajior Dal. Wazid Ali Choudhury, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly, said the decision by the Congress leadership followed repeated criticism of the party by its ally. “Akhil Gogoi has constantly been criticising the Congress party and its leaders. We got tired of the fact that he was in an alliance with us and

still criticising us,” he said. The erstwhile junior ally chose to train its guns on Lok Sabha MP and Assam Congress chief Gaurav Gogoi, questioning the scale of his engagement with the flood crisis.

While he opted not to put up a candidate in Nagaon in the interest of “preventing the rise of communal forces”, the Rajior Dal chief is eyeing a larger chunk of the Opposition space over the full term of the BJP-led government. The party won two seats in the April election, Mr. Akhil Gogoi defending his Sib-sagar seat from 2021 and Mehboob Mukhtar winning Dhing LAC in Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency.

It could have added a third to its kitty, but the Congress’s veto forced Rajior Dal to drop Sherman Ali Ahmed as its candidate from Mandia; Mr. Ahmed

promptly walked over to the Trinamool Congress and secured the party its sole seat.

Rajior Dal’s long game

With only one non-Muslim among the Congress’s 19 winning candidates, the Rajior Dal’s long game is clear: expand at the expense of the principal Opposition party among the Assamese Hindu voters, a prospect even Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma had predicted in February this year.

The Muslim vote isn’t a settled question either. The Congress wrested back much of this electoral constituency from the AIUDF in the last Assembly election after refusing to renew its tie-up from 2021, but dismal performances across seats with a thin minority concentration leave it vulnerable to another

shift. Mr. Ajmal set the cat among the pigeons as early as August 16 when he claimed - correctly, in retrospect - that the Congress will not field a Muslim candidate in the bypoll. By fronting himself as a candidate, the AIUDF chief, currently an MLA from central Assam’s Binnakandi seat and a former three-time MP from western Assam’s Dhubri, is going all in to reclaim the party’s core constituency. The arithmetic aligns: Nagaon has four Muslim-majority Assembly segments, Dhing, Rupahihat, Lahorihat and Samaguri, and four others - Nagaon-Batadraba, Jagiroad, Morigaon and Raha; over 55% of the parliamentary constituency’s voters are minorities.

The BJP and AIUDF, with their respective Nagaon picks, have boxed the Congress in from both

flanks. State BJP chief Dilip Saikia and the CM have acknowledged the odds in a ‘non-traditional’ seat. The BJP is betting on a non-Muslim consolidation for Mr. Devasish Sharma, the former Nagaon Deputy Commissioner whose transition from bureaucrat on September 3 to BJP politician five days later sparked Congress outrage. The strategy, the CM spelled out, is to maximise its advantage in the four non-minority-heavy segments and narrow deficits in the rest.

Mr. Ajmal and Mr. Salam’s candidatures ensure that every Muslim vote would be equally fought for. A Congress victory could only come about if it manages to draw support across sections of voters - essentially making its old winning formula work. The party could not afford to alienate non-minority

voters with a Muslim pick, having won the Lok Sabha seat twice in succession even as it slipped elsewhere against the BJP. The Nagaon poll is thus Congress’s to lose. “Congress will secure victory once again in the Nagaon bypoll. Consider this as an announcement,” Mr. Gaurav Gogoi had said even before the party announced its choice. A win here would indeed signal a vital shift: a diverse electorate, bridging religious divides, voting the Congress candidate first past the post and giving the party a credible shot at taking on the BJP five years down the road. A failure would mean the fundamental factor underlying its Assembly election rout persists - an inability to appeal to the Assamese Hindu voters beyond a certain threshold.

Revanth lists extent of land owned by KCR and family

M. Rajeev
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has alleged that Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) president and former CM K. Chandrashekar Rao and his family members amassed hundreds of acres of land in the name of the Telangana Statehood agitation and after the party came to power in 2014. As per the list released by the CM in the Assembly on Wednesday, Mr. Rao and his wife own 67.13 acres of land at Erravalli, Mittapalli and Shivar Venkatapur villages in Siddipet district in violation of the Land Ceiling Act.



Revanth Reddy

to 439.3 acres spread over nine districts, 24 mandals and 31 villages.

“We have seen people agitating for a cause losing everything. But one family benefited immensely in the name of Statehood agitation,” he said. Mr. Reddy said the Erravalli farmhouse where Mr. Rao stays spans 700 acres. Of this, 388 acres are assignment lands (government land given to farmers for cultivation). “My government will inquire into it,” he said.

The CM added that the government had decided to distribute the land parcels among 800 Dalit families, as a fitting reply to the BRS leaders who, he alleged, had “cleansed the path traversed by the Dalit families”.

“This is only part one of the revelation. Other issues will come out in due course,” said Mr. Reddy.

439 acres in all
BRS working president and MLA K.T. Rama Rao possesses 123.19 acres in villages in Siddipet and Rangareddy districts, while KCR's daughter K. Kavita and her husband own 37.26 acres. Another family member and BRS deputy floor leader T. Harish Rao and his wife own 30.16 acres. Another member, Joginapalli Santosh Kumar, and family own 79.2 acres. Mr. Rao's relative Naveen Kumar owns 101.14 acres in Medchal-Malkajgiri, Rangareddy, Sangareddy and Siddipet districts. This takes the total land assets of the family

Telangana CM urges SC to quash FIR on ‘cash for vote’

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Wednesday sought the quashing of the FIR in a 2015 cash-for-vote case, arguing in the Supreme Court that the pre-amendment version of the Prevention of Corruption (PC) Act had not considered the alleged offering of a bribe an offence at all.

Appearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of

India Surya Kant, senior advocate Siddharth Luthra argued that Section 12, which covered abetment of offences under the PC Act, only pertained to the bribe-taker.

It was only after amendments to the Act in 2018 that offering a bribe to a public servant was made an offence, Mr. Luthra contended. Mr. Reddy, the then Deputy Floor Leader of the Telugu Desam Party, was allegedly caught on camera offering ₹50 lakh as part of a ₹5-crore “payment”.



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Lakhwinder Kour W/O Manjeet Singh R/O Village Tanda, Tehsil Vijaypur and District Samba went missing from Supwa lsamba, but thereafter she did not return home, her search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.04 dated 16.05.2008 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Description Roll:-	
Name:	LakhwinderKour
Parentage	Manjeet Singh
Permanent Address:	Village Tanda, Tehsil Vijaypur and District Samba
Age:	22yrs
Height:	5'2 ft.
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	Oval
Attire:	Salwar Suit



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10533/26, Sep 15 2026



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Kaka Ram S/O Rasella Ram R/O Aamli Tehsil Samba went missing from samba, but thereafter he did not return home, his search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.17 dated 26.12.2003 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Kaka Ram
Parentage	S/O Raseela Ram
Permanent Address:	R/O Aamli Tehsil Samba 75yrs
Age:	75yrs
Height:	5'7
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	Round
Body Structure:	Normal
Language:	Dogri/ Gojri
Attire:	Kurta pjama



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10459/26, Sep 15 2026



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Kuldeep Raj S/O Ram Dass R/O Vill. Giggian Teh. R.S Pura Distt. Jammu went missing from SIDCO Phase-01 samba, but thereafter he did not return home, his search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.10 dated 04.03.2017 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Kuldeep Raj
Parentage	Ram Dass
Permanent Address:	Vill. GiggianTeh. R.S PuraDistt. Jammu
Age:	35 Yrs
Height:	5 Feet 4 Inch
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	Oval
Body Structure:	Normal
Language:	Hindi, Dogri
Attire:	Pent Shirt



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10536/26, Sep 15 2026



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Hirah Sharma W/o Suresh Kumar R/o Katli Samba went missing from samba, but thereafter she did not return home, her search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.31 dated 29.06.2024 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Hirah Sharma
Parentage Permanent	w/o Suresh Kumar
Address:	Katli Samba
Age:	43 yrs
Height:	152.4 cm
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	round
Body Structure:	Normal/medium
Language:	Hindi /Dogri
Attire	Salwar Suit



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10510/26, Sep 15 2026



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Gian Chand S/O Punjabu Ram caste Mahashe R/o Rayour samba went missing from samba, but thereafter he did not return home, his search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.08 dated 13.12.2014 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Gian Chand
Parentage	S/o Punjabu Ram Caste Mahashe
PermanentAddress:	R/o Rayour Samba
Age:	55 Yrs
Height:	5'6
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	Round
Body Structure:	Normal
Language:	Dogri
Attire:	Kurtapjama



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10511/26, Sep 15 2026



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

" HUE & CRY NOTICE"

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Kalo Devi W/O Chhaju Ram R/O Chak Manga Rakwal Teh. & Distt. Samba went missing from samba, but thereafter she did not return home, her search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.05 dated 25.01.2013 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1.PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2.SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
3.SHO PS Samba :- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Kalo Devi
Parentage	Chhaju Ram
PermanentAddress:	Chak Manga RakwalTeh.& Distt. Samba
Age:	50 Yrs
Height:	4 Feet 4 Inch
Complexion	Wheatish
Face:	Oval
Body Structure:	Healthy
Language:	Hindi, Dogri
Attire:	Salwar Suit



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP/J-10458/26, Sep 15 2026



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(An Autonomous Institute under Govt. of Jharkhand)
Ranchi, Jharkhand

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झारखण्ड सरकार

स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग

प्रेस विज्ञापित

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक स्वंगर्ग के सह-प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एम0जी0एम0 चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, कुलो ज्ञानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख मिर्खापुर चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर **Walk-In-Interview** के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार सह-प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक / कम हो सकती है:-

क्र0सं0	विभाग का नाम	कुल रिक्ति	UR	ST	SC	BC I	EWS
1	एनाटोमी	4	2	0	1	1	0
2	फिजियोलॉजी	2	1	0	1	0	0
3	बायोकेमेस्ट्री	1	1	0	0	0	0
4	पैथोलॉजी	3	2	1	0	0	0
5	औषधि	9	8	1	0	0	0
6	षिषु रोग	1	1	0	0	0	0
7	सर्जरी	3	2	1	0	0	0
8	अस्थि	2	2	0	0	0	0
9	ई0एन0टी0	2	1	0	1	0	0
10	नेत्र	4	2	1	0	1	0
11	स्त्री एवं प्रसव	1	1	0	0	0	0
12	निश्चेतना	4	1	2	0	0	1
13	चर्म एवं रति रोग	3	3	0	0	0	0
14	रेडियोलॉजी	6	3	1	1	1	0
15	रेडियोथेरेपी	5	3	1	0	1	0
16	टी0बी0 एण्ड चेस्ट	1	1	0	0	0	0
17	फिजिकल मेडिसिन एंड रीहेबिलिटेशन	2	1	1	0	0	0
Total		53	35	9	4	4	1

अर्हता :- सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वॉजित अनुभव लागू होगा।

चयन का आधार :- **Walk-In-Interview** के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा विलित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अनिलखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरुद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुसूची की जायेगी।

नियुक्ति की शर्तें :-

- सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने के लिए एम0सी0आई / एन0एम0सी0 के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वॉजित अनुभव संबंधी प्रावधान लागू होंगे।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय-समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता / सुविधा देय नहीं होगी।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएँ अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रोन्नति, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होंगी।
- 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरान्त उनके चयनितवृद्धवम का मृत्युंकन संतोषजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्षों हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।
- संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबंधिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु वयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।
- अवकाश :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों को कैंपेचर वर्ष के लिए राज्य कमियों के अनुरूप आकस्मिक अवकाश देय होगा, परन्तु अन्य किसी अवकाश के इकदार नहीं होंगे।
- किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त सह-प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।
- सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में सह-प्राध्यापक के उत्तरे ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरे जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु आकाश प्रविष्टि का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।
- वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिमण्डल द्वारा लिए गए निर्णय के अनुसार संविदा सति निर्माण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प-407 (6) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (6) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलेख में सह-प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय 2,00,000 /- (दो लाख रुपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगी।

अधिकतम उम्र सीमा :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी पदों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।

रिक्त पदों पर वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू रिस्सा, सैंची के प्रशासनिक चयन में निम्नांकित दिशियों में सम्पन्न होगा :-

क्र0सं0	पदनाम	दिनांक	समय
01	सह-प्राध्यापक	21.09.2026	10:30 AM

सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाईट :- www.jharkhand.gov.in/health के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वॉजित सूचनाएँ पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वअभिप्रमाणित छायाप्रति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय भाग लेंगे।

इस विज्ञापन को स्थगित करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं स्थित के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक,
चिकित्सा शिक्षा, झारखंड, सैंची

PR 389807 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare(26-27)D



JHARKHAND URBAN INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LIMITED

(A Government of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO BHAWAN, KUTCHERY CHOWK, RANCHI 834 001, JHARKHAND.
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Jharkhand Urban Infrastructure Development Company (JUIDCO) Ltd., a company under the administrative control of Urban Development & Housing Department, Govt. of Jharkhand, is engaged in the different infrastructure development work, such as, (i) Water Supply Projects (ii) Sewerage, Septage & Drainage Projects (iii) Flyovers, Roads, Bus Stands ISBT & Transport Nagar (iv) Park Projects & Development of Water Bodies (v) Pradhan Mantri Aavas Yougna (PMAY) (vi) Iconic Buildings (vii) Namami Gange Projects etc.

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Detailed terms and conditions, Eligibility criteria along with the application Performa can be downloaded from our official website juidco.jharkhand.gov.in at Resources Head under Job Opportunities Section.

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No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-03/764/2026-27
Date: 16.09.2026

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(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB invites tender from reputed consultants/firms under two cover bid system with vast experience and proven record of similar nature of work for project mentioned below:-

Name of the work : 1) Providing consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) Preparation of Economic Analysis, Feasibility Report, Surveying, Layout Plan Design, Preparation of Cost Estimates, Cost Structure etc., for the Formation of PM-Mitra Textile Park at Kalaburgi. (Extent 1000 Acres). 2) Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the Formation of Housing Layout at Narendra-Mummugatti Industrial Area, Dharwad Taluk & District. (Extent 111 Acres).

The last date and time for Submission of bids : **29.09.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**

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DIPR/CP/2776/NR/2026-27
Chief Engineer -2 KIADB, Bengaluru



On the one hand, India would prefer to continue being paid for its exports in dollars. A depreciating rupee ensures that every dollar paid to India results in a higher amount of rupees. As a country looking to boost exports, India would want to retain this advantage. On the other hand, India is also a major importer and would like to pay in relatively cheaper local currencies. It will eventually have to choose. Then there is the fact that China accounts for about two-thirds of all BRICS exports. BRICS local currency trade will largely be trade in the yuan. Relations with China might be thawing now, but India would still be loath to conduct its business in the yuan. It is also important to distinguish between local currency trade and a BRICS currency. While India has so far been cautiously supportive of the former, it has been vocal in opposing a BRICS currency, largely because of China's likely dominance of such a currency. Then there is U.S. President Donald Trump's threat of 100% tariffs on countries adopting a BRICS currency. India has displayed a pragmatic approach to dealing with Mr. Trump, and it will not court such tariff threats lightly. Countries such as Iran and Russia have pressing reasons to move away from the dollar. So far, India does not have a convincing enough one, and the New Delhi Declaration reflects that.

The survival of the pygmy hog depends
on a thriving ecosystem

Even now, the difficulty of spotting and counting these animals means that it is hard to say how many exist in the wild; per the Durrell Wildlife Conservation Trust, there were some 250 individuals in early 2025, with the last surviving natural population in the Panbari grasslands area of the Manas National Park. Since they continue to be threatened, the captive individuals form the insurance group, but even so, the group's long-term evolutionary fitness is still not guaranteed. Researchers are also alert to the accumulation of harmful gene variants in the population and low genetic diversity, and thus look forward to the pygmy hog's natural habitats being restored. Alluvial floodplains are dynamic ecosystems; in addition to threats such as land conversion, efforts to 'save' them, such as widespread dry-season fires, can still destroy the dense cover the pygmy hog needs. On the other hand, suppressing ecological processes can leave trees and shrubs to turn grassland into woodland. Given the plan to increase the wild pygmy hog population to 300 by 2040, Assam needs to revert the fragmentation of its protected grasslands, especially in Rupahi and Kanchanbari, and to restore buffer zones around the Manas and Orang National Parks and the Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary.

The cultural nationalism that the RSS represents considers all Hindus around the world as one nation, but it also holds strident views about the territory of India. The RSS anthem is the Sanskrit hymn *Namaste Sada Vatsale Matribhume*, underscoring the primacy of territory even while claiming Hindu universalism. Secularists, on the other hand, also draw upon

Varghese
K. George

The ‘internal enemy’ theme

Hindutva’s foundational author, V.D. Savarkar, framed this concern about the split loyalties of those residing in the territory. In *Hindutva: Who Is a Hindu?*, he distinguished between those who are in the territory of India by the accident of birth and those who consider it their sacred land.

The true Hindu, in his formulation, is one who has India as both *pitrubhumi* and *punyabhumi*, a test that excludes Muslims and Christians who may have their sacred lands elsewhere. This fear of the resident alien, or even the enemy within, continues to persist in Hindutva thinking. Mr. Bhagwat himself has spoken of this. “This war is not against an enemy without, but against an enemy within. So there is a war to defend Hindu society, Hindu Dharma and Hindu culture. Foreign invaders are no longer there, but foreign influence and foreign conspiracies continue...” he told *Organiser* in an interview in 2023. This theme of the internal enemy continues to animate Hindutva nationalism, at any rate, a vocal section of it.

contradictions in the Sangh's ideas about the people and territory that make up a nation

practices are contradictions, and perhaps a struggle to come to terms with a changing world. The Sangh has become a global actor, partly by accident and partly by design. Mr. Bhagwat also maintains that all people who are in India and share the same ancestry are all Hindus.

If all people who share the same ancestry are Hindus and part of the nation, there is no reason why the RSS should be anxious about the movement of people from anywhere in the subcontinent. But that is not the RSS's position, which calls for the stringent protection of Indian borders and the removal of so-called infiltrators by all possible measures.

Migrations linked to colonialism dispersed Indians across distant shores. Wherever Indians settled, the anti-colonial movement also took root. Intellectual and organisational strands of the Indian national movement were present in many parts of the world in the early 20th century. In fact, both Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi and Vinayak Damodar Savarkar developed their ideas while living in the United Kingdom.

Diaspora dilemma

The visible emergence of Hindus in the West as a political community in recent decades has been a double-edged sword for Hindutva. The U.K. has had a Prime Minister of Hindu faith, Rishi Sunak. The RSS and the Bharatiya Janata Party introduced a new vocabulary of the *jannmahoomi-karmabhoomi* duet when they launched their diaspora politics under Atal Bihari Vajpayee's government. This worked quite well in reaching out to western audiences until native nationalisms in the West began to view migrants with suspicion. It so happened that the RSS's intensive diaspora politics, which became part of India's state policy under Mr. Modi, coincided with the rise of nativism in the West. Mr. Bhagwat's London speech sought to address this concern: Can a person of an allegedly foreign faith be a loyal citizen of the country?

If this moment is truly one of self-reflection and marks an evolutionary milestone for the RSS in its 100th year, it must apply the same standard everywhere, across the entire *bhumi*. What is true in London must be equally true in Lucknow: loyalty to the nation is not determined by the faith one follows, but by one's residency and the modern concept of citizenship. Mr. Bhagwat has done well in stating that people of Indian origin must choose their adopted country over India in all situations, echoing Jawaharlal Nehru's position on this question. However, Mr. Bhagwat's words will be tested equally in the Indian context if they are to be accepted as a marker of the RSS's evolution.

varghese.g@thehindu.co.in

A shifting security order

The announcement comes at an interesting moment in the evolution of West Asian geopolitics. The United States-Israeli war against Iran, the fracturing of Gulf security assumptions, disrupted energy flows and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, and rising Türkiye-Israel tensions have all pressed on Chinese interests. Pakistan's brokering of a U.S.-Iran understanding which Beijing supported, offered a template for extending influence without exposure. Then came the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement on August 7, 2026 between Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Türkiye.

In theory, a North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)-style mutual defence agreement would

Manoj Kewalramani
Chairperson,
Geostrategy
Programme,
Takshashila
Institution

The Chinese President's visit to Egypt has outlined Beijing's approach

not be welcome in Beijing. Over the years, the Chinese leadership has repeatedly pushed back against what it says is Cold War mentality and bloc politics. But in this case, it has been extremely cautious. There has been no formal comment, no direct leadership statement, and no word from its ambassadors. That, however, does not mean that there has not been an internal debate.

Mecca pact, Chinese views

For instance, Long Chen of Renmin University's Chongyang Institute has argued that the Mecca pact might actually serve American purposes. Every administration since (then) U.S. President Barack Obama has sought to shed direct security costs, the 2025 National Security Strategy says as much explicitly, and regional states arming themselves is precisely what offshore balancing requires. He noted that all three signatories remain dependent on American weapons and intelligence. Of course, what all of this ignores is the difficult security relationship that Mecca pact members have with Israel, a key American ally in the region.

Others such as Zhou Li, a former Vice-Minister of the International Department of the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China has argued that the pact is an exercise of regional strategic autonomy, produced by the erosion of American hegemony, and consonant with China's Global Security Initiative. Mr. Zhou has contended that comparing this agreement to a NATO-style treaty is foolhardy, as there is no published text, no joint command, no cost-sharing, and no binding obligation.

Essentially, Mr. Zhou concludes that such a pact dilutes American primacy without creating a rival bloc that Beijing would have to position itself against. Mr. Zhou also suggested that the next member to join the agreement could be Egypt, which is where Mr. Xi's statement and the choice of venue for it are significant. In calling to "unleash the internal momentum of regional common security", Mr. Xi seems to have weighed

in on the domestic debate, leaning in favour of Mr. Zhou's argument.

What likely prompted him to do so is the belief that while Washington remains the preponderant military power in the region, its ability to defend allies against Iranian strikes, to enforce its will in the Strait, and to sustain commitment as its dependence on Gulf energy declines are all now open questions. Gulf states are, therefore, hedging, buying insurance from Pakistan and others. In other words, the American credibility problem has become an opportunity too juicy to miss out on. This is a moment during which Beijing can throw cautious support behind attempts among regional actors to pursue autonomy, with little practical cost to itself.

Beijing's interests

China has significant economic and energy stakes in West Asia. If regional states are building their own architecture, Beijing can support the process economically and remain militarily disengaged. It already has substantial defence and technology trade with Pakistan, growing ties with Saudi Arabia, and openings in Türkiye and Egypt. Saudi Arabia and Egypt together absorbed roughly a third of China's combat drone deliveries in the decade to 2023, according to Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) data. Riyadh has also built domestic solid-fuelled ballistic missile capacity with Chinese technical assistance and is increasingly attracting Chinese technology investment. So there could be money to be made and influence to be cemented in terms of defence and technological engagement.

In essence, the formula announced by Mr. Xi in Cairo is a significant position being articulated with regard to the emerging security framework in West Asia. Whether this framework will demand certain guarantees that China remains reluctant to offer is something that must be noted going forward. More interestingly, it seems that despite all the friction, Beijing and Washington might be able to find some common ground in West Asia.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The UPI charge

It is strange that at a time when India's UPI has gained wide acceptance both at home and abroad, a 0.4% charge is being introduced on merchant transactions above ₹2,000. The government says about 96% of merchant transactions will remain free, leaving only 4% to bear the new charge. This

raises a basic question: what sizeable amount is expected to be gained from this measure? The answers are not clear.

There is also a risk that some merchants may find ways around the charge. They could ask customers to pay into their personal accounts, which remain free, instead of their business accounts, or ask

them to split a large payment into smaller amounts of ₹2,000 or less. Others may simply pass the cost on to customers by raising their prices. UPI has made everyday payments simple for millions. There is little sense in complicating a system that has worked so well.

V. Nagarajan,
Chennai

Weaponised space

The disclosure by the United States that it possesses counter-space capabilities, although it has not revealed their nature, could open the floodgates to the weaponisation of space. While orbital bombardment has so far remained largely within the realm of science fiction, the deployment of kinetic or

non-kinetic conventional weapons in space could make it a reality. This could trigger an arms race, with space powers deploying their weapons in orbit. At a time when the global space industry is seeking cheaper and more affordable technologies for conducting space missions, an arms race in space could hinder progress towards reducing

satellite-launch costs. It could also undermine scientific missions, including exploration and research, as countries divert resources towards weapons rather than scientific advancement.

Kunal Anand,
Bhubaneswar, Odisha

Letters emailed to
letters@thehindu.co.in
must carry the postal address.

Mining amendment is unfair to States

India's mineral wealth is not evenly spread across the country. States such as Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, and Karnataka possess enormous reserves of coal, iron ore, and other minerals that feed industries across India. While mining brings in investment and employment, it also leaves the host State to deal with challenges such as the resettlement of displaced groups; environmental damage; pressure on public infrastructure; and the long-term consequences of extracting minerals that can never be replaced.

That is why the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act (MMDR), 2026 deserves closer attention. At the heart of the amendment is Section 9D which restricts State Governments from imposing taxes, cesses or other levies on mineral rights or mineral-bearing land except in accordance with conditions prescribed by the Central government. The Centre says the measure is intended to create a predictable tax environment, prevent excessive levies, and to encourage long-term investment in mining. There is an understandable economic argument behind that objective. Mining projects involve enormous investments and operate over decades; investors need to know that the financial rules will not change unpredictably from one year to another. However, this logic has been contested by the States.

The real question is not merely whether States will continue receiving the royalty, the auction premium and other



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revenues they receive today. The Centre claims that 90% of mining sector revenue accrues to the States and that this will continue. The larger concern is about what States may be prevented from earning tomorrow.

A mineral-rich State possesses a natural economic advantage. Ordinarily, one would expect it to have some ability to use that advantage to raise resources for its own development. Section 9D substantially reduces that freedom by making future State levies related to minerals dependent upon a framework controlled by the Centre. This matters enormously for States whose budgets are closely connected with mining. NITI Aayog's Fiscal Health Index has highlighted the strong performance of Odisha and Chhattisgarh in mobilising revenue and has specifically recognised the role played by mining receipts. In Odisha, mining has accounted for a large proportion of the State's non-tax revenue. Mineral producing districts often require greater public expenditure because they bear the costs of mining.

The federal problem

The constitutional issue is equally significant. The Constitution gives States the power to tax mineral rights under Entry 50 of the State List, although Parliament can impose limitations on that power through laws relating to mineral development. States also possess a separate constitutional power to tax lands and buildings under Entry 49 of the State List.

In 2024, a nine-judge Bench of the Supreme Court in *Mineral Area Development Authority vs. Steel Authority*

of India held, among other things, that royalty payable on minerals is not a tax. It also recognised the States' legislative power to tax mineral rights and held that mineral-bearing land can fall within the States' taxation power over land. The 2026 Amendment risks rendering the impact of this judgment nugatory.

While Entry 50 permits Parliament to place limitations upon State taxation on mineral rights, Section 9D of the amending statute goes further by extending its restriction to taxes or levies on mineral-bearing lands. That is likely to raise an important debate: how far can a Central law dealing with mineral development restrict a State's exclusive power to tax land? The issue is larger than mining policy alone. It concerns the relationship between the Union and the States.

India's federal system cannot function effectively if States have responsibilities without financial capacity. A State that bears the infrastructural and social consequences of mineral extraction must retain a meaningful stake in the economic value generated from its natural resources. Uniformity may make taxation more predictable, but predictability should not come at the cost of narrowing the fiscal choices available to States.

The debate over the MMDR Amendment should therefore not be reduced to a contest between promoting investment and imposing taxes. The minerals beneath a State's soil may serve the entire country, but the costs of extracting them are felt most directly by the people who live above them.

What India's growth really means

India's 7.8% real GDP growth in April to June 2026 is an extension of a strong economic journey – real GDP grew 7.2% in 2023-24, 7.1% in 2024-25, and 7.7% in 2025-26. The latest rate exceeds the RBI's 7% forecast despite the West Asian conflict, high energy prices, and uncertain trade. Its real significance, however, lies in the breadth of production and demand.

Real GDP, which is the value of goods and services after adjusting for inflation, rose to ₹81.36 lakh crore, while real GVA, the value added by farms, factories and services before adjusting for product taxes and subsidies, grew by 8.2% to ₹73.82 lakh crore. Manufacturing rose by 9.2%, utilities 8.9% and construction 7.7%, lifting the secondary sector by 8.6%. Services grew by 10%, led by finance, real estate, IT and professional services at 12.1%. Agriculture grew by 3.6%, although mining contracted by 2.4%. This is broad-based growth with identifiable weak spots.

This strength is reinforced by demand. Gross fixed capital formation grew by 11.9%, private consumption by 7.1% and real exports 12%. Using the same gross fixed capital formation measure for 2023-24, investments by private corporations were 10.3% of GDP. While the general government invested 4.2%, total public sector investment was 7.8% when adding in investments by public corporations. Moreover, when adding in household investments, mainly housing and unincorporated businesses, total non-public investment was 24.1% of GDP. That is, while public capital



Gourav Vallabh

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expenditure has built the platform, the next acceleration requires more private investment.

Fast growing economy

The base year change is simple. A base year removes inflation and reflects the economy's structure. Updating it from 2011-12 to 2022-23 replaces an outdated market basket with today's products, services and prices. Some estimates may rise and others fall, but changing the ruler does not shrink the economy. On comparable year-on-year data, India's 7.8% exceeded Malaysia's 6%, Singapore's 5.9%, Indonesia's 5.29%, and China's 4.3%.

India is therefore among the fastest growing major economies. Its expanding market supports global demand for energy, technology, machinery and services, while offering a trusted location for diversified supply chains. This advances India's path to becoming the world's third largest economy in nominal terms. Since rankings also reflect prices and exchange rates, the milestone will endure only if real growth leads to higher productivity, stronger firms, and better household incomes. Employment is the decisive test. India added 17.19 crore jobs between 2014-15 and 2023-24, according to RBI KLEMS-based data. The next employment revolution must improve job quality through productivity, wages, formalisation, social security and skilling. While women's labour force participation reached 41.7% in 2023-24, safe transport, affordable childcare, flexible work, credit and market access are essential to bring many more women into

productive employment.

Manufacturing must move from assembly to design, components, machinery, electronics and clean technology, while services must spread beyond metros into tourism, health, education, logistics, finance and Indian language digital businesses. AI preparedness must move from adoption to original capability through domestic compute, Indian language data, research talent, and trusted applications. India must also make proper use of Free Trade Agreements (FTAs). An FTA utilisation mission should guide firms on rules of tariffs and markets. MSMEs need hand-holding on non-tariff barriers through shared testing, affordable certification, standards, customs support and buyer discovery. Moreover, external ambition requires domestic resilience. India should counter energy risks through diversified suppliers, long term contracts, strategic reserves, renewables, domestic exploration and efficiency. Timely infrastructure, predictable regulation, easier credit, and stable taxation can crowd in private investment.

The 7.8% quarter warrants confidence, not complacency. India must convert public capital expenditure into private investment, job numbers into quality employment, and FTAs into opportunities for MSMEs. If energy and macroeconomic stability accompany inclusion, productivity, and transparent measurement, becoming the third largest economy will be more than a statistical milestone. It will become a foundation for broad-based prosperity.

SIR deletions: elector numbers in 1/3 of Delhi below poll turnout

The number of electors left in the roll – 94.9 lakh – is 97% of the total number of actual voters who turned up to vote in the 2025 elections

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Devvyanshi Bihani
Srinivasan Ramani

In more than one third of the 70 constituencies in Delhi, the number of deletions following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process has been so high that the draft roll in these seats have been left with fewer electors than the actual number of those who voted in the February 2025 Assembly elections.

If one were to trust that the Election Commission (EC) process has been fair, one should believe in the following astounding possibilities: that everyone who has been deemed to be an “ordinary resident” in these 24 constituencies had voted; a significant chunk who voted are no longer there; and that those who did not vote during the 2025 polls were not ordinarily resident then or have ceased to be so in the 17 months between the polls and the commencement of the SIR. In other words, these constituencies witnessed inward and outward migrations of enormous scale in this period alone.

However, there are no signs that any of these things happened. In such a situation, it stands to reason that in merely a year and a half since the Assembly elections, conducted by the EC itself, the changes would not be so dramatic that deletions would entail the electorate to reduce to a number lower than the turnout figures.

Since the draft enumeration process involves electors listing their EPIC numbers and their eligibility to vote in the elections, it stretches reason to assume that the recent voters deemed themselves as ineligible.

This is just the draft roll, and there is still time for electors to be added to the lists – both freshly eligible ones and others who have been erroneously deleted from the rolls. But the slapdash nature of

the SIR process is evident in the fact that the Union Territory has now been left with only 97.5 lakh electors in the draft roll.

Evidence from elections

In February 2025, the electoral rolls had 1.56 crore electors, of which 94.9 lakh electors turned out to vote.

This number in the draft rolls follows two stages of culling names – one prior to the SIR when close to 11 lakh electors were deleted and later, the draft SIR phase when nearly 47.6 lakh electors were deleted (**Chart 1**).

The Tughlakabad constituency is where the SIR process has made the deepest cut in these terms. In the current draft rolls, there are only 1,00,386 electors, which is 14,575 fewer than the 1,14,961 voters who actually turned out to vote in 2025.

Chart 3 lists 15 of the 24 constituencies in Delhi which have fewer electors now than the actual turnout in 2025. This oddity is most pronounced in the eastern, central and southern parts of Delhi; highest especially in seats beyond the Yamuna river on the east.

The number of electors left in the roll – 94.9 lakh – is 97% of the total number of actual voters who turned up to vote in the 2025 elections with just a “buffer” of around 2.6 lakh electors to leave room for those who were ordinary residents, but did not turn out to vote.

In other words, if all the deletions since the Assembly polls are legitimate, based on the draft rolls, now, the hypothetical turnout percentage would be an implausible 97% (**Chart 2**).

Interestingly this pattern of leaving a small “buffer” of electors is more marked for States and UTs who have undergone the SIR in Phase 3 – Andhra Pradesh (8.8%), Karnataka (13.1%), Maharashtra (16.2%) and so on. In other words, as the SIR went from phase to phase, the pattern of deletions left fewer “buffer” electors, with Delhi being the “worst” case.

Numbers that do not add up

The data for the charts were sourced from publicly available information on the websites of the Election Commission of India. For Chart 2, turnout figures of 2024 LS polls or Assembly elections in respective States / UTs, whichever happened closer to SIR, were taken for analysis



CHART 1: Of the 1.56 crore electors who were on the rolls before the Delhi Assembly polls in February 2025, 94.9 lakh had voted. Since then, over 58.5 lakh names have been removed

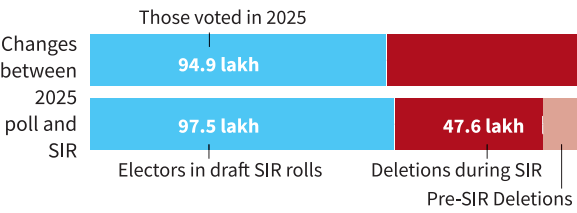
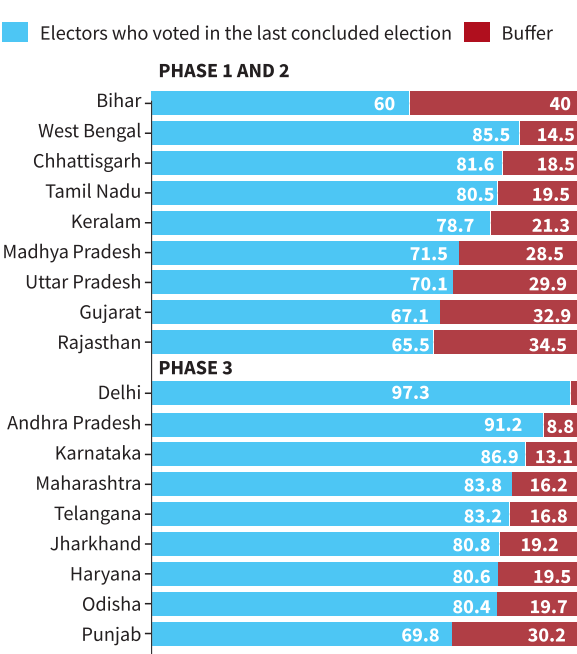
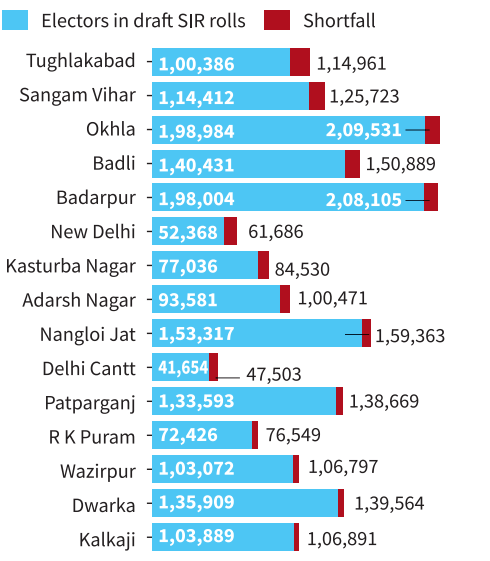


CHART 2: The share of those who voted in the elections before SIR, compared with the electors in the draft SIR rolls. The “buffer” has shrunk noticeably in Phase 3 of the SIR

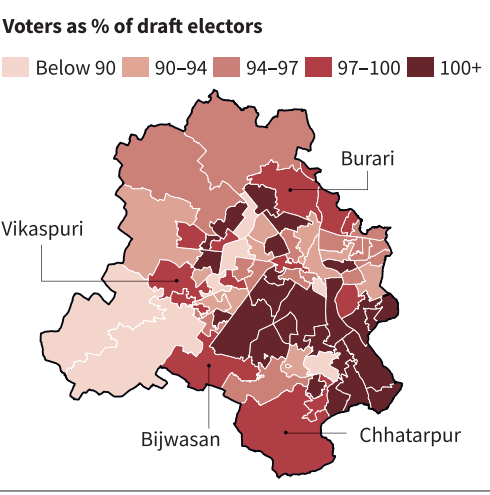


‘Buffer’ indicates the share of draft SIR rolls which includes eligible electors who did not vote in the last election, but continue to remain ordinary residents of the respective places. A narrow buffer of 2.6% in Delhi indicates high possibility of aggressive deletions and potential disenfranchisement of eligible voters

CHART 3: The 15 constituencies with the highest shortfall in the draft SIR rolls when compared with actual voters (shown outside the bars) in the 2025 polls



MAP 1: This shows those voted in 2025 as a share of electors in draft SIR rolls. 100% or more means those ACs have fewer electors than those who voted in 2025



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu**

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 17, 1976

Calicut customs hunt for hidden gold

Calicut, September 16: The Calicut customs are trying to unearth gold biscuits worth lakhs of rupees suspected to have been hidden in a big tank in the midst of paddy fields at Poyilkavu, near Quilandy, for the last 20 years. A bund has been built across the tank and water is being pumped out to-night and the authorities hope to strike pay dirt to-morrow evening.

Mr. Dayasankar Karanth, Assistant Collector of Customs, who is in charge of the operation, said that in 1956 the customs had made a big haul of smuggled gold biscuits from the Kaapiad shore (the famous coastal point where Vasco da Gama landed) worth about Rs. 20 lakhs then. It was a big catch and came to be known as “Kaipad seizure.” The gold biscuits, in cloth jackets, had been tied to rocks under seawater about a furlong from the shore. Intelligence reports since then had indicated that part of this smuggled gold had already been removed to shore before the customs men got scent of it and been dumped into the tank.

About six months ago, according to a report, a group of nearly dozen men tried to dig this gold out from the tank without the knowledge of the owner of the tank. On the first night they almost succeeded but the appearance of a snake terrified them and put them off. The next night also they made a secret attempt with the help of a ‘manthravadi’ to scare the snake away but they met with no success.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 17, 1926

Mystery of magnetism

Calcutta, September 17: An interesting discovery, which promises to throw light on the mystery of magnetism and its relation to Chemistry has been made by Professor C.V. Raman, F.R.S, and his associates in the research in Calcutta. By using highly sensitive refined optical methods, it has been demonstrated that molecules of all common liquids, or paraffin for instance, when placed in a strong magnetic field, orientats and tend to place themselves, so that certain favoured directions are parallel to the field. Investigation shows every molecule in its liquid state to possess different magnetic properties in different directions and actually enables these differences to be measured and connected with the chemical structure of molecules.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Decline in Manipur's revenue amid ethnic conflict in 2023-26

1,200 Manipur Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh on Wednesday said the prolonged ethnic conflict in the State resulted in a decline of over ₹1,200 crore in GST revenue from 2023 to 2026. The ethnic conflict has claimed at least 306 lives, with 49 people still missing and thousands rendered homeless, officials said. PTI

Number of additional employees coming under the EPFO

51 in lakh. The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a proposal to raise the wage ceiling for mandatory coverage under the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) to ₹25,000 per month from ₹15,000. The wage ceiling revision is taking place after 12 years. The decision is expected to bring more than 51 lakh additional employees within the ambit of EPFO coverage. PTI

Household listing blocks covered in Bengal Census phase 1

1.73 in lakh. West Bengal has completed 100% of the fieldwork for the first phase of the Census, covering all 1,73,066 HLBs across the State ahead of the September 14 deadline, CM Suvenhu Adhikari said. Over 3.68 crore census houses have also been enumerated against a projected 3.69 crore, representing nearly 99.7% of the expected households. PTI

Number of casualties in Sudan gold mine collapse

67 The tragedy happened in the al-Zara gold mine in the town of Nuhud in West Kordofan province. The area is under the control of the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces, which have been at war with the country's military for over three years. Survivors said the collapse occurred late Tuesday, and many people remain missing at the mine. PTI

Number of vehicles to be seized from police stations in Bengaluru

11,000 Karnataka Minister Krishna Byre Gowda on Wednesday launched a drive to shift over 11,000 seized vehicles from police station premises across the city to seven designated locations, aimed at clearing the premises and easing inconvenience to the public. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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What lies beyond India's E20 push

The E20 blend's promised savings were offset by lower mileage, with consumers spending an estimated ₹88,234 cr. extra over the last three years; its benefits for emissions and forex savings are uncertain, as higher fuel consumption can raise emissions while diverting crops to ethanol can affect food security and exports

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad
Shouvik Chakraborty
Indranil Chowdhury

A litre of E20 petrol consists of 80% motor gasoline and 20% anhydrous ethanol. According to a press release by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, India first introduced it on February 6, 2023, when public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) began selling it at select outlets across the country.

E20 promise

E20 has been scaled up this year because of rising crude prices resulting from unilateral American aggression against Iran and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz in response. The government has made three broad claims in favour of using the E20 blend – savings for the consumer, lower carbon emissions, and forex savings. However, if the E20 blend reduces mileage, these claims may not hold. That the loss in mileage is real was accepted in a written reply to the Lok Sabha by Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari, who stated that E20 reduces fuel economy by “2% to 6% depending on vehicle category and vintage,” citing a joint ARAI-SIAM-IOCL study. There is also anecdotal evidence from many car users, especially those using cars of vintage 2022 or earlier, that E20 has brought mileage down, perhaps by far more than 6%, as well as caused damage to their engines and oil tanks. It is difficult to quantify the possible engine damage this blend may cause, but these three claims are empirically verifiable.

Has it saved Indians some cash?

The first claim is that since the E20 blend uses less crude, which is expensive, and more ethanol, which is cheaper, a higher share of ethanol will save Indians money. This, it is claimed, would also help keep inflation in check. But what this claim does not take into account is the loss in mileage (km/litre) that a higher ethanol blend leads to. Since ethanol releases less energy per litre burnt than pure gasoline, there is a consequent loss of mileage per litre, especially in engines that are not compatible with the E20 blend.

Let us say E10 blend petrol used to cost ₹100, and E20 was introduced while keeping prices the same, which is what happened.

Consider an average mileage of 15 km/litre for a standard car running on the E10 blend. If there is a 6% loss in mileage with E20, the car would now need 1.06 litres to travel those 15 km. This means shelling out ₹106 instead of ₹100 for the same distance travelled. Aggregate this over many customers and many kilometres, and you get the loss that households have to bear. The greater the loss in mileage, the greater the cost to the household would be.

An extensive report prepared by The Reporters Collective and authored by Ayushi Kar shows that, instead of savings, the households had to spend extra as a result of this loss in mileage. **Chart 1** shows that over the last three years, Indian consumers had to shell out an additional ₹88,234 crore, with the burden rising every year. If the defence is that prices would have been much higher had the E10 blend continued, there are other ways in which prices could be kept under check, at least in the short run.

The question of emissions

On the face of it, E20 is definitely a

India's changing fuel mix



BOX 1: Emissions calculations for 15 kms travelled by an average Indian car

	E10	E20
Emissions*	2.32 KgCO ₂ /ltr	2.23 KgCO ₂ /ltr
WITH 6% LOSS OF MILEAGE		
Petrol needed	1 ltr	1.06 ltr
Emissions	2.32 KgCO ₂ (A)	2.23 x 1.06 = 2.37 KgCO ₂ (B)
Excess Emissions if using E20		0.05 KgCO ₂ (B-A) = 50 gCO ₂

***Note:** 1. Emissions data has been taken from the Federal Register EPA, which reports E10 emissions to be 8.78 kgCO₂/gallon and pure ethanol's 5.75 kgCO₂/gallon. 1 gallon = 3.79 ltr
2. We calculate the implicit emissions from 100% gasoline, which is 9.12 KgCO₂/gallon, and use that to generate E20 emissions.

CHART 1: E20's extra cost to Indian consumers (in ₹ crores)

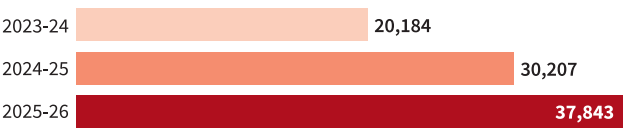
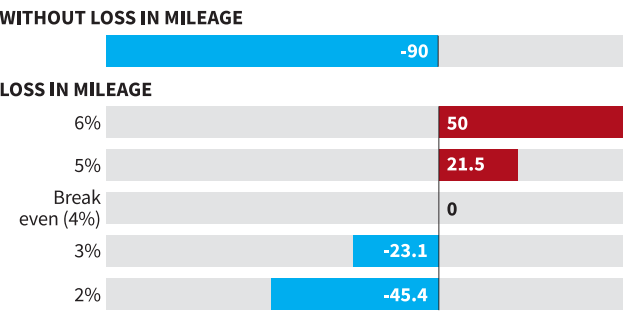


Chart: Ayushi Kar (2027) “In 3 years, Indian motorists paid ₹88,234 crore extra fuel Modi govt's Great Ethanol Experiment”, Reporters Collective

CHART 2: Do the CO₂ emissions decline with E20?

(Difference in emissions between E20 and E10 in gCO₂ per 15 km of an average Indian car)



See box 1 for details

Chart: Authors' calculations | **Source:** Federal Register, EPA

cleaner fuel simply because less carbon is embodied per litre of ethanol (**Box 1**). But, as we saw above, with a loss in mileage, the same 15 km now requires 1.06 litres of petrol, which means emissions could be higher for the same distance travelled. Box 1 shows the difference in emissions if there is such a loss in mileage.

In Chart 2, we present the rise or fall in emissions using this calculation for the entire range of mileage losses given by the Minister. The calculations show that emissions would rise (red bars), rather than fall, if the loss in mileage is in the range of 4% to 6%. Emissions fall only if the loss in mileage is less than 4%.

To be sure, overall emissions per km would depend on the mix of cars of different vintages running on Indian roads. For newer cars compatible with E20, emissions are likely to decline. For older cars, on the other hand, emissions would be greater, depending on the extent of the loss in mileage. Thus, average emissions per km would depend on the weights of different vintage cars.

E20 and foreign exchange

Any substitution away from crude will indeed save India foreign exchange since oil constitutes a significant part of the import bill.

However, the position needs to be more nuanced. First, a fall in mileage may

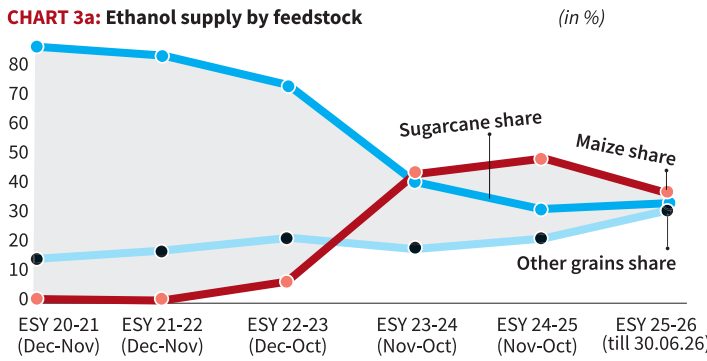
at least partially cancel out the advantage of the blend as far as forex savings are concerned. Second, the ethanol required for E20 blending needs diversion of crops and grains in favour of ethanol production. The diversion of food grains for fuel has serious implications for food security. Since E20 blending is here to stay, this is more of a long-term adjustment in the supply of such crops and grains.

A demand-production mismatch for an agricultural commodity will either be met by rising prices, cross-border trade management, or both. The resulting fall in exports, or increase in imports, or both, represents a loss of foreign exchange, undermining the very purpose that initiated the policy shift. It might be too early to ascertain the long-term impact of this policy on forex earnings, but some preliminary evidence may give us a sense of where this is headed.

The two main sources of ethanol production are sugarcane and maize (Chart 3(a)).

While India has gradually shifted away from sugarcane to maize, both crops have been affected by this policy. In the case of sugar, the government had to ban exports in 2023 as well as this year, amid rising domestic demand because of ethanol diversion. This led to a drastic fall in India's dollar earnings from sugar exports (Chart 3(b)). As for maize, with a rising

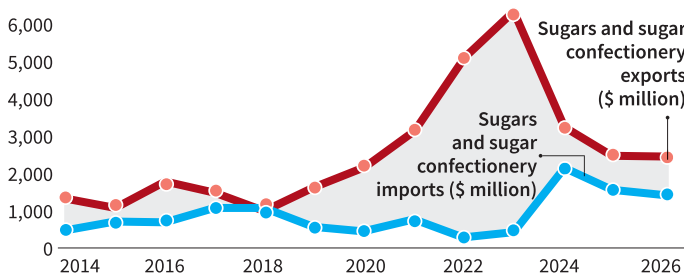
E20 promises savings and lower emissions, but mileage losses and crop diversion could offset some of its gains



ESY is Ethanol Supply Year. ESY definitions change over time: Dec-Nov for ESY20-21 and ESY21-22; Dec-Oct for ESY22-23; and Nov-Oct from ESY23-24 onward. The ESY25-26 column is a part-year figure, up to 30.06.2026

Source: Authors' calculations. Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, Government of India, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Question no – 1729, Answered on – 03/08/2026

CHART 3b: Sugars and sugar confectionery trade, 2014-26



Data for HS Code 17 - Sugars & sugar confectionery - have been used for this chart
Source: Authors' calculations. Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India. Frequency is Annual, ending in "March" of each year

CHART 3c: India – maize trade, FY2014–FY2026 (in \$ million)

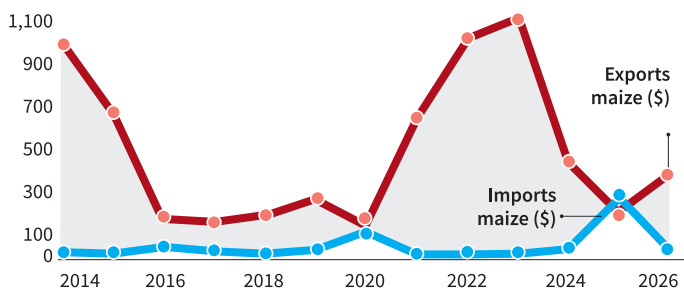


Chart: Authors' calculations. The 8-digit HS code for maize until 2020 was 100591000 and for maize seed was 10051000, respectively. Since 2021, the codes for different maize product categories have been 10059011, 10059019, 10059020, 10059030, and 10059090. The code for maize seed remains the same. Frequency is Annual, ending in "March" of each year.

Source: Ministry of Commerce and Industry, GoI

share as a source of ethanol production, export earnings have similarly plummeted over the last couple of years (Chart 3(c)). India was a net importer last year.

So, even in the narrow sense of improving forex earnings, the E20 policy may not have been entirely successful.

The cost beyond the pump

To keep prices under control when crude prices rise, a countercyclical indirect tax policy could be introduced to insulate consumers, something that the government itself was doing until the Bengal elections were over.

As the Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) himself has argued, consumers should, at the very least, be given a choice between E10 and E20 instead of forcing a fleet of vehicles – cars and motorcycles – that are not ready for E20 to use it.

The government should also develop reliable and subsidised public transport with last-mile connectivity, along with cycling and walking options. All of these would reduce the need for cars and motorcycles, and hence emissions and pollution.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics; Additionally, Shouvik Chakraborty is Research Associate Professor at the Political Economy Research Institute, Amherst, U.S.)

THE GIST

E20 was introduced to reduce dependence on crude, but its lower energy content can reduce fuel economy, increasing the cost of running vehicles

The emissions impact depends on the extent of mileage loss and the vehicle's vintage, while diverting sugarcane and maize to ethanol production has implications for food security and trade

The government can use countercyclical fuel taxes, offer consumers a choice between E10 and E20, and strengthen public transport, cycling and walking infrastructure to reduce fuel use and pollution

BIBLIOGRAPHY



An artist rendering released by NASA shows NASA's Voyager 1 spacecraft barreling through space.. FILE PHOTO

What Voyager’s journey tells us about the purpose of exploration

Three books revisit the journey of humanity's longest-running spacecraft through the solar system to ask what drives our curiosity, to what end, and what it tells us about our place in the universe

Vasudevan Mukunth

Come November, Voyager 1 will be around one light-day away from the earth. That means light will take one day to travel from our home planet to the spacecraft. The Voyager missions are two identical spacecraft NASA launched in 1977 to explore the outer planets. Voyager 1 and Voyager 2 made historic flybys of Jupiter and Saturn; Voyager 2 also visited Uranus and Neptune. Both spacecraft later became humankind’s most distant operating probes. Today, Voyager 1 is at the outer limits of the solar system, and has been for a few years. The spacecraft had to travel at 17 km/s on average for roughly 17,900 days just to get to the picket fence at the end of its little neighbourhood – a day’s journey for light. On the other hand, our telescopes have captured breathtaking visuals of distant celestial wonders, from the Pillars of Creation to the Orion Nebula, from the Sombbrero Galaxy to Hoag’s Object, thousands to millions of lightyears away. It is entirely possible humans may never see them up close firsthand, but who knows what the future will bring?

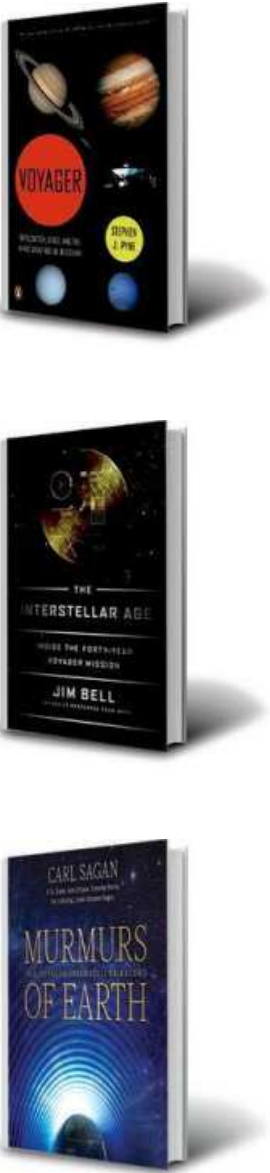
Looking back
In his 2010 book *Voyager: Exploration, Space, and the Third Great Age of Discovery*, historian Stephen Pyne divides writers on exploration into “lumpers” (who look for grand, unifying patterns across history) and “splitters” (who focus on the unique, specific characteristics of

individual expeditions, nations, or eras). The proto-lumpers, he says, hold that humans’ urge to explore lies somewhere in the genome itself; that it is providential. But where Pyne’s book really shines is when it takes a closer look at those who elected to not explore, unearthing how history shaped the ways in which we think about exploration today. Ming China launched seven magnificent fleets before curtailing oceangoing. He writes, “Medieval Islam sponsored great travellers before shrinking into the ritual pilgrimage of the haj. The Norse spanned the Atlantic, then withered on the fjords of Greenland.” According to Pyne, exploration is not some kind of anthropological necessity but an institution sustained by certain rivalries. Like the Aborigines of Oceania, he went on, “Plenty of peoples ... felt little urgency to search beyond the daunting seas or looming peaks.” It can be a dispiriting notion. Exploration is what we do when we rise above the squalor and the misery. Or is it? Pyne guides readers to a more special, and somehow more comforting, thought: that exploration could be all that it has been purported to be if it provides a journey into a wider moral universe that helps us understand who a people are and how they should behave. And you can have this experience as much on the shores of Neptune’s rings as with, to borrow from Rainer Maria Rilke, the “great wide sounds” of the sea crashing down over you at the beach.

The Interstellar Age, by planetary

scientist Jim Bell, recounts a kindred example: the story of how Voyager 1 nearly did not take the Pale Blue Dot image. The picture, for which Voyager 1 had to turn back towards the sun while risking damage to its cameras so it could photograph the earth, had no scientific content – yet it is arguably the mission’s most consequential yield. The astronomer Carl Sagan, upon beholding it, came to his famous conclusion about how we should treat each other. **Our place in the universe** Scarcity is an important part of how we have come to understand exploration: we are told the mind can afford to rise above squalor only after there is no squalor at all, that we must choose between bread or roses. But Bell explains how Voyager 1 itself cost only around one dime per American person per year over its lifetime. Almost always, there is enough for bread as well as roses. This goes for India, too, where necessitous spending by the government on the space programme has become something of a bogeyman. In fact, as the Pale Blue Dot image, among many others, illustrated, the mission delivered to humans an inestimable gain: a sense of place in the universe. As if extending that sense, *Murmurs of Earth: The Voyager Interstellar Record* is pointed in its assertion that the Voyagers’ Golden Records were designed to “join a commonwealth of space-faring societies”. Each Golden Record was a copper disc

plated with gold, containing sounds, music, images, and greetings from the earth in 55 languages (including Tamil and Telugu), plus instructions to locate the planet. For being co-written by Sagan, who also chaired the committee that selected the Records’ contents, *Murmurs* remains a relatively obscure book, in part because it went out of print two decades ago. Its text recounts how the Golden Records were made and why they contain the information they do, written by the people who built them. And it says that this team agreed to exclude mentions of war, disease, crime, and poverty. As the American science journalist Jon Lomberg (who also co-authored *Murmurs*) says in *The Interstellar Age* about what kind of influence the team wanted the Records to have: “It was like asking ourselves, ‘Could we measure up to the Voyager Record?’ This is us at our best, or at least not at our worst. This approach made the record aspirational...”. But if *Voyager* is any guide, the aspiration is also paradoxical: if rivalry is the most reliable engine of a great age of exploration, a pacified, egalitarian world simply may not explore. In the end, nothing can implicitly justify the impulse to explore because it is never just an impulse. It is always purposeful, and thus needs to be collectively owned, internationally authored, unenclosed, and answerable to the people paying for it, even if – or especially if – it inspires them.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

“Hi, come on in. Did you get a cake from your neighbour this morning?”
“Why should she give me a cake?”
“Today is Christmas; that’s why! Doesn’t she usually give you a big cake?”
“Yeah, she does. But this year, she’s celebrating Christmas in Goa.”
“That’s nice. But is that the reason you’re looking so grumpy? The fact that you didn’t get a Christmas cake?”
“No, I am not angry about that. I am angry with your friend Sujatha. We had another one of our fights.”
“You and Sujatha fighting again! Was it about some silly movie?”
“No, it was about the word ‘handsome’?”
“The word ‘handsome’, eh? Did she insult you by calling you ‘handsome’?”
“Even if I were the last man on earth she would never call me that and you know it. No, the argument was over whether a woman could be called ‘handsome’. I said that the word handsome could be used only with men. She argued that a woman could be called handsome as well. So, tell me. Is she right? Or am I right?”
“She is, actually.”
“What? You mean I can tell someone that Shanti is a handsome woman.”
“Well, I wouldn’t use the word handsome with a young girl like Shanti. You see, mature women can be called ‘handsome’, not young girls.”
“So when you call a woman handsome, are you implying that she is manly?”
‘No, no! Handsome does not mean manly. When you refer to a woman as being handsome, what you are implying is that her features are fairly large and regular rather than pretty and delicate.’
“.... in other words, she is not much to look at.”
“On the contrary, she is very pleasant to look at. The famous Swedish actress Greta Garbo was often referred to as being ‘breathtakingly handsome’.”
“So a woman who is fairly well-built, has big eyes and a big nose is more likely to be called ‘handsome’ rather than pretty?”
“You know what they say, beauty lies in the eye of the beholder.”
“The next time I see Sujatha I have to tell her that she was right. I hate doing that. Tell me, what have you been up to?”
“Oh, nothing much actually. I have been trying to psych my new boss out.”
“Psych your new boss out?”
“The expression has several meanings. One of the meanings of ‘psych someone out’ is to try and figure the person out.”
“In other words, you try and understand the person. How his mind works. Is that what you are saying?”
“Exactly! Here’s an example. No matter how hard I tried, I just couldn’t psych Janaki out. She’s a bit....”
“...I don’t think anyone can psych her out. Anyway, tell me what are the other meanings of psych out?”
“When you psych out about something, you become very excited about it. You may even lose control over your ability to think.”
“When the students came to know that Sachin was to be the chief guest at the Annual Sports Day event, they all psyched out.”
“But later when the students came to know that it was going to be the Chief Minister and not Sachin who was going to be the chief guest, everyone was disappointed. No one psyched out.”
“That is to be expected, I guess.”
Published in The Hindu on December 25, 2001

THE DAILY QUIZ

Hashim Thaçi, the former president of Kosovo, has been sentenced to 25 years in prison for war crimes by a tribunal in The Hague. A quiz on other such leaders

Joan Sony Cherian

QUESTION 1
Thaci was convicted by the Kosovo Specialist Chambers of The Hague. What is the mandate of these Chambers?
QUESTION 2
Which sitting Prime Minister currently has an arrest warrant against him issued by the International Criminal Court (ICC) in 2024?
QUESTION 3
This British supermodel once testified in a trial against this former Liberian president at the Special Court for Sierra Leone in The Hague. Name the

supermodel and the Liberian leader.
QUESTION 4
In 2023, the ICC issued an arrest warrant against Russian President Vladimir Putin for war crimes in Ukraine. Along with Putin, it also issued a warrant for another Russian official. Name the individual.
QUESTION 5
In 2016, this leader was convicted by the ICC to 18 years’ imprisonment for war crimes and crimes against humanity committed in the Central African Republic. However, the leader was ultimately acquitted by the court after an appeal. Name the leader and his current position.



Visual question:
This leader became the first ex-head of state to stand trial before an international court since World War II. However, he died before judgment could be delivered. Name him. AFP

Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. Name the British Antarctic Survey scientists whose 1985 paper reported the Antarctic “ozone hole”. **Ans: Joe Farman, Brian Gardiner and Jon Shanklin**
2. What 1985 international treaty, signed by 20 countries and the European Economic Community, established the framework for later ozone regulations? **Ans: The Vienna Convention for the Protection of the Ozone Layer**
3. When did the Montreal Protocol enter into force? **Ans: January 1, 1989**
4. Who is often called the “father of the Montreal Protocol” for his role as UNEP’s head in brokering the deal? **Ans: Mostafa Kamal Tolba**
5. What 2016 amendment added a phase-down of hydrofluorocarbons under the Protocol? **Ans: The Kigali Amendment**
Visual: Identify this French physicist. **Ans: Charles Fabry**
Early Birds: K.N. Viswanathan | Prem Raj P. | Aanchal Lakra | Lalchand Bhutani | Sunil Madhavan

Correction: The answer to Question 4 in the Ganesha quiz is Siddhi and Riddhi and not as published. The error is regretted.

Word of the day

Nugatory:
having no purpose or value

Synonyms: empty, worthless, vain, futile, useless

Usage: The criticism was nugatory and was quickly forgotten.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/nugatory

International Phonetic Alphabet: /njuːɡətəri/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

From Page One

Pak. corvette collides with Indian Navy ship

The Pakistani diplomat was advised to convey to the authorities in Pakistan the need for all military units to exercise due care and respect the provisions of relevant bilateral agreements to prevent a recurrence of such incidents. The Indian Chargé d'affaires in Islamabad has been instructed to lodge a similar protest with Pakistan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, the government said.

PNS Hunain is a Yarmook-class offshore patrol vessel built by Damen Shipyards in Romania and commissioned into the Pakistan Navy in July 2024. It is about 98 metres long and is designed for maritime security, surveillance, and patrol missions. It has a flight deck and can transport a helicopter and an unmanned aerial vehicle, besides carrying two rigid-hull inflatable boats for maritime-security tasks. The latest incident comes amid the continued deployment of Indian and Pakistani naval assets in the Arabian Sea.

EPFO wage ceiling hiked to ₹25,000 a month

Mr. Mandaviya added that the employees' contribution towards the EPS will also increase to about ₹2,082.5 a month – 8.33% of the new ₹25,000 ceiling – from the present amount of ₹ 1,250. He added that from 51 lakh to up to one crore workers will get the benefit of the decision.

“Too little, too late”

All India Trade Union Congress general secretary Amarjeet Kaur said the decision is too little and too late. “The last time the ceiling was increased was in 2014. Considering the inflation, it should have been at least ₹30,000. The employees may see that their take-home salary will decrease. So the government must ensure that the employers are paying their share in a transparent manner, rather than making it part of the cost of the company and shifting the burden to employees,” she said. National chairman of the Association of Indian Entrepreneurs K.E. Raghunathan said the EPFO's software must be upgraded to handle the additional volume of subscribers. “Employers, especially MSMEs, would find it very tough to absorb the additional strain on their outflow, especially when most of them are struggling to make any profit. The Government of India must absorb this increase for two years in the case of MSMEs,” he said. .

‘No change to panel probing police action’

On August 20, the court had tasked the panel headed by former apex court judge, Justice R. Subhash Reddy, to look into issues and allegations, including those of police excesses on students during nationwide protests against NEET-UG paper leaks.

Beside Justice Reddy, the committee includes Justice Ravi Shankar Jha, former Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court; Justice Shalinder Kaur, former Judge of the Delhi High Court; Rishi Kumar Shukla, former Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation; and L.R. Bishnoi, retired Director-General of Police, Meghalaya.

The petitioners, represented by senior advocates N. Hariharan, Gopal Sankaranarayanan, advocates Prashant Bhushan, Vrinda Grover and Neha Rathi, had clarified that they were not apprehending bias, but the committee should inspire confidence too. But the court expressed a sense of chagrin that the disparagement from the petitioners' side had commenced even before the HPEC had started work.

“We are constrained to observe, with some measure of disquiet, that aspersions have been cast upon the HPEC in a manner that is both premature and precipitate. In the circumstances, we are not inclined to effect any alteration in the constitution of the Committee, particularly where the prayer for such reconstitution proceeds on nothing more than conjecture and preconceived notions, articulated even before the HPEC has embarked upon its enquiry,” the Supreme Court observed in its September 10 order, published on Wednesday. “The HPEC is not created to espouse the causes of one or the other party before us,” the court said. The court reiterated that the immediate focus of the HPEC inquiry would be on the use of pellet guns, the targeted violence, harassment of female protesters, and the excessive violence and destruction of property by both sides.

Saudi Arabia says Houthis targeted Mecca

The Saudi-led coalition battling the Houthis vowed retaliation, saying “the security of the Two Holy Mosques and the pilgrims is a red line”.

“The coalition will not hesitate to take the necessary and deterrent measures against the Terrorist Houthi Militia.”

Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said Saudi Arabia had launched more than 450 strikes on Yemen this week, and that in response, the group had targeted a Saudi air base in the south and a state oil company facility in the Red Sea port city of Yanbu.

The Organisation of Islamic Cooperation – a bloc of 57 Muslim countries – condemned the “heinous attacks”, while Arab League chief Nabil Fahmy called it “a matter of extreme gravity”.

Jhiram Valley attack: all 10 convicts get death penalty

27 people, including senior Congress leaders, were killed in the 2013 attack by Maoists; former Chhattisgarh CM Bhupesh Baghel says those who hatched and executed the plan still remain free

Shubhomoy Sikdar
RAIPUR

A special National Investigation Agency (NIA) court in Jagdalpur, Chhattisgarh, has awarded the death sentence to all 10 convicts in the 2013 Jhiram Valley Maoist attack. Twenty-seven people, including senior Congress leaders Vidya Charan Shukla, Nand Kumar Patel, and Mahendra Karma, were killed in the attack on May 25, 2013.

Earlier on September 5, the NIA court convicted 10 persons – Pramila Modiyam, Chaitu Lekam alias Munna, Sumitra alias Sumitra Punem Modiyam, Mukka Mandvi, Kosa Kavasi alias Kosaram, Aayata Markam, Madkami Deva, Joga Madkami, Banjami Snna alias Chamru alias Denga, and Mahadev Nag – for the killings.

During the trial, the agency informed the court that members of the banned Communist Party of India (Maoist) attacked a convoy of about 20 vehicles carrying Congress leaders. The attackers triggered a landmine blast that blocked the route of the vehicles participating in the *Parivartan Yatra*. This was followed by indiscriminate firing and grenade lobbing, resulting in 24



Trial time: A view of the Jagdalpur-based special court, which delivered the verdict on the Jhiram Valley attack. ANI

deaths on the spot and injuries to over 35 persons.

Senior Congress leaders Nand Kumar Patel, Mahendra Karma, Uday Mudaliyar, and Dinesh Patel, and 10 police personnel were among those killed on the spot. Later, three victims, including former Union Minister V.C. Shukla, died.

The attackers stole nine AK-47 rifles, seven INSAS rifles, two SLRs, four 9mm pistols, and magazines before fleeing.

The NIA had filed charges against 39 people, including two top Maoist leaders, Thippiri Tirupathi, alias Devuji, and Barse Deva, who surrendered recently. They were listed as wanted while the trial was ongoing. The initial trial against the 10 chargesheeted persons concluded after recording

leaders involved in the conspiracy behind the attack be booked.

“Those who hatched the conspiracy and those who executed the massacre are still roaming free. At whose behest, one wonders, the NIA had already dropped the names of top Naxalite leaders; they were not even charged. Neither the NIA nor the commission of inquiry investigated the conspiracy. BJP leaders consistently created hurdles and prevented the investigation. There is no question of the court's verdict altering our perspective. We still maintain that justice remains incomplete because the investigation itself was incomplete,” former Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel posted on X.

CM's reaction

Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai hailed the verdict as a victory for justice and credited Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah for eradicating Naxalism from India.

He said it is a time for introspection, especially for those who play “politics on the corpse of tribal communities and those who provide intellectual and ideological support to terrorism”.

In post-BRICS outreach, Jaishankar reaches Bhutan; Nepal Minister to visit Delhi today

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar arrived in Thimphu on Wednesday for a two-day visit to discuss India's development assistance, while Nepal Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle will arrive in Delhi on Thursday for talks that are expected to discuss India's support for Nepal's reconstruction post-floods, as the government intensifies its outreach in the neighbourhood.

Last week, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh travelled to Colombo, in the first such visit by an Indian Defence Minister in nearly four decades, to strengthen strategic ties.

Mr. Jaishankar met with Bhutan Foreign Minister Lyonpo D.N. Dhungyel for



External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar with his Bhutanese counterpart, Lyonpo D. N. Dhungyel, on Wednesday. PTI

bilateral discussions at Bumthang in central Bhutan. “Our conversation focused on advancing our multifaceted engagement in development partnership, energy, trade, connectivity, culture, and people-to-people ties,” Mr. Jaishankar said in a post.

The Ministers also laid the foundation stone for a

hydropower project, and inaugurated a bridge and a hospital. On Thursday, he will meet Bhutan's fifth King Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck and call on Prime Minister Tshering Tobgay, the Ministry of External Affairs said in a release.

Meanwhile, Mr. Wagle will land in Delhi on Thurs-

day for talks with Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and other Ministers. He will also meet a number of diplomatic and economic experts and academics during his two-day visit.

Mr. Wagle will also be expected to clarify Nepal Foreign Minister Shishir Khanal's remark that India, China and the U.S., as “climate polluters”, should pay “compensation” to “countries like Nepal that have faced the impact of global warming, which is now a regional threat.

Missed opportunity

The visits come within days of the BRICS Summit, where the government hosted leaders from more than 20 countries, but none from India's neighbourhood. The lone South Asian invitee, Bangladesh

CBI books Timothy Initiative, six others over fund routing

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Central Bureau of Investigation has registered a case against seven accused, including a U.S.-based organisation called The Timothy Initiative, in connection with the alleged routing of foreign funds into India, including to regions affected by left-wing extremism, through foreign debit cards.

Those named in the first information report (FIR) are The Timothy Initiative, an international Christian evangelical organisation; Jonathan S. Rajan, Micah Mark and Ajit Verghese Mathai from Bengaluru, and Supreme Joy from Mysuru, in Karnataka; Bablu Kurmi from Goalpara in Assam; and Varghese Chacko from Dhamtari in Chhattisgarh.

The agency, which recently received inputs from the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in the case, has invoked provisions of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), the Information Technology Act, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita against the accused persons.

The FIR alleges that the others entered into a criminal conspiracy with The Timothy Initiative, withdrawing funds from overseas through various ATMs across India using foreign debit cards issued by the

The CBI invoked provisions of the FCRA, the IT Act, and the BNS against the accused persons

U.S.-based Truist Bank. An estimated ₹92.55 crore was sent from November 2025 to April 2026, allegedly in contravention of the FCRA, while about ₹44 crore was withdrawn using debit cards across multiple States, including Karnataka, Chhattisgarh, and Assam, from January 2024 to March 2026.

When Mr. Mark was intercepted by the ED at Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru, on April 18, he had on him 24 foreign debit cards of Truist Bank and all of them had the name ‘Santosh Kumar’ printed on them, the CBI said. “The same was carried out on the instructions of Ajit Verghese Mathai so as to avoid suspicion by law enforcement agencies, and in violation of KYC norms to conceal the real user, thereby forging the real identity and using fraudulent means to evade the law,” the FIR alleged.

The ED's searches revealed that Mr. Mark had made several trips abroad and returned with foreign debit cards. Over 1,000 such debit cards have been distributed in India over the past few years.

Network led by Shahzad Bhatti listed as terror group

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Union government on Wednesday designated the Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN) a terrorist group under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) said in a notification that through its terrorist activities, the outfit led by Pakistani gangster Shahzad Bhatti poses a “serious threat to the democratic system, communal harmony, and internal security of the country”. On August 15, over 200 people were arrested in a country-wide anti-terror operation that was linked to the SBN.

Bhatti, who speaks Punjabi and has a significant social media presence with regular posts on Instagram and Facebook, has been operating out of the United Arab Emirates (UAE), the officials said. Over the last one and a half years, he is said to have “graduated” from organised crime to “terror-related activities”.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said in a post on X, “Pursuing PM Shri @narendramodi [Narendra Modi] Ji's vision of zero tolerance against terror, the MHA declares the Shahzad Bhatti Network as a terrorist organisation under the UAPA.” The SBN is the 46th group to be designated a “terrorist organisation” under the UAPA.

Without mentioning the specific cases against the network, the MHA notification listed nine categories of crimes registered against the group under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the Information Technology Act, the Explosives Substances Act, the UAPA, the Official Secrets Act, the Immigration and Foreigners Act, and the Delhi Prevention of Defacement of Property Act.

HC seeks response from Centre, U.P. on journalist's detention

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday sought responses from the Centre, the Uttar Pradesh government, and the Gautam Buddha Nagar District Magistrate on a *habeas corpus* petition challenging the preventive detention of journalist Satyam Verma under the National Security Act, 1980, in connection with the April 2026 Noida workers' protest.

A Bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev issued notices to the authorities concerned. The next date of hearing in the matter is October 7.

In the plea, Mr. Verma challenged his detention

order passed by the District Magistrate on May 12, along with the State government's subsequent approval and confirmation orders. He has sought quashing of the orders, his immediate release and compensation for “illegal” detention.

The plea said that the detention order wrongly places Mr. Verma at the site of violence in Noida on April 13. It claims that CCTV footage and call detail records show that he was in Lucknow that day and was detained by the Hasanganj Police around 3.30 p.m. It further alleged that Mr. Verma was not named in any of the 11 FIRs relied upon for his detention.

Ladakh must get Centre's promises in writing: Omar

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

J&K Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Wednesday advised Ladakh leaders “not to trust verbal promises of the Centre.”

“I can advise them (Ladakh leaders) as a friend and elder brother: Do not trust the verbal promises of the Centre. We have suffered it on the demand of Statehood. We were promised Statehood immediately after the assembly elections. Around two years have already passed,” he said.

“Till Ladakh does not have anything in writing, they will not achieve anything,” Mr. Abdullah said.

New Delhi rejects Pak.-China Boundary Joint Commission

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India on Wednesday rejected the Boundary Joint Commission set up by Pakistan and China, saying that the body has no legal basis to decide on arrangements related to Indian territory under illegal occupation.

New Delhi's reaction came following the first meeting of the Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission in Islamabad. India has been maintaining that Pakistan's handing over of certain territories such as Shaksgam Valley to China in 1963 is illegal and unacceptable.

It has also opposed the China-Pakistan Economic

Corridor as part of it passes through Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK).

“Our position on this matter is clear and consistent. There is no boundary between Pakistan and China. We reject the so-called Joint Commission, which is without any legal basis,” External Affairs Ministry spokesman Randhir Jaiswal said on the Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission. The entire Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh “have been, are and will always remain integral and inalienable parts of India”, he said. He said that India has never recognised the so-called ‘China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement’ of 1963.

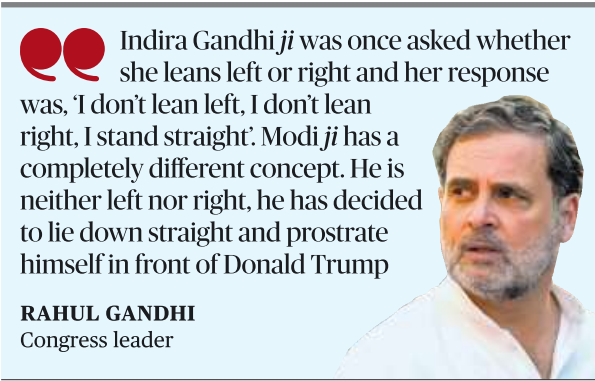
PM decided to prostrate before Trump, says Rahul on UPI fee

Modi govt. gave in to U.S. demand to get rid of zero MDR for UPI, says Jairam, questions if move intends to benefit U.S. card companies; Kharge terms U.S. threat of higher tariffs on countries buying oil from Russia a failure of India's foreign policy

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Mounting a sharp attack on the Narendra Modi government over the introduction of a charge on certain UPI transactions, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday accused the Prime Minister of “prostrating” before U.S. President Donald Trump, and demanded an immediate rollback of the decision.

In a video posted on X, Mr. Gandhi said Mr. Modi had “decided to lie down straight and prostrate himself in front of Donald Trump”, and accused the government of imposing a “UPI tax” on Indians to give “a huge amount of money” to the United States.



“Indira Gandhiji was once asked whether she leans left or right and her response was, ‘I don’t lean left, I don’t lean right, I stand straight.’ Modiji has a completely different concept. He is neither left nor right, he has decided to lie down straight and prostrate himself in front of Donald Trump,” Mr. Gandhi said. “Modiji, stop lying down in front of the U.S.,

have a spine, stand up and rollback the UPI tax,” Mr. Gandhi added.

The Congress has sought to link the UPI decision to what it describes as growing U.S. pressure on India, including demands for changes to the zero merchant discount rate (MDR) regime for UPI. The party has also stepped up its attack following moves in the U.S. Congress to im-

pose tariffs on countries buying oil and gas from Russia.

Congress general secretary in charge of communications Jairam Ramesh said the U.S. Trade Representative had earlier criticised UPI for being free and for having displaced card companies such as Visa and Mastercard.

“Here, the Modi government has given in to a U.S. demand to get rid of zero MDR and charge for UPI,” Mr. Ramesh said, questioning why the rate had been fixed at 0.4% and whether the move was intended to enable U.S. card companies to compete with UPI.

“The PM has redefined NOTA – Narendra’s Ongoing Trump Appeasement,” he said.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, reacting to the U.S. tariff legislation,

said the threat of higher tariffs showed that the government’s foreign and trade policies had “miserably failed”.

“From tariffs and trade to H1B1 immigration, visas and digital payments, the pressure from Washington keeps mounting, and you, ‘Howdy Modiji!’ keep surrendering!” Mr. Kharge said on X.

Earlier, Congress media and publicity department head Pawan Khara said: “We are not playing ball with America and China. We are the ball.”

The government, however, said the new MDR is not a charge on consumers.

Congress spokesperson Supriya Shrinete rejected the government’s position, saying the move would ultimately increase costs for ordinary users.

RSS affiliate urges govt. to look at ‘broader savings’ before imposing UPI fee

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Ashwani Mahajan, co-convenor of the Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM), the economic wing of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), on Wednesday raised concern about the government’s proposed merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions above ₹2,000, calling for the move to be reconsidered. He argued that the fee was not justified by the costs involved.

In a post on X, Mr. Mahajan said there was little reason for banks to seek an MDR on UPI, pointing out that the digital payments system had helped bring down their costs in terms of ATMs and other infrastructure. “UPI transaction fee is most unfortunate. It’s demeaning an achievement of Bharat, which has global appeal. Policymak-



Centre has proposed a 0.4% MDR on merchant payments above ₹2,000 through UPI.

and smaller merchant transactions will not attract the fee.

“The question is, why them too?” Mr. Mahajan said, arguing that even bigger merchants shouldn’t be taxed for accepting UPI payments.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Mahajan referred to concerns he had raised in a recent article about the United States Trade Representative and India’s zero-MDR system. The SJM co-convenor said the government should not change its policy because of such pressure. He said the growth of UPI had reduced the business of international card networks such as Visa and Mastercard and helped India save on foreign exchange outgo. “The government should look at the broader savings generated by UPI before going ahead with the proposed fee,” he added.

IPS officer transferred for using Arabic salutations

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government in West Bengal has transferred IPS officer Bushara Bano, after right-wing groups raised objections against a video in which she is heard using common Arabic salutations and greetings. Ms. Bano, who was posted as Additional SP of Kharagpur, has been transferred to the post of Deputy Commandant, SAP 4th Battalion.

In the video, in which Ms. Bano reflects on her personal journey, she is heard saying, “Assalamu Alaikum! I am a 2021-qualified IPS officer and currently deployed as Additional Superintendent of Police in Kharagpur...”

Oman pitches new port that could expand India’s access to Gulf energy

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

With the Strait of Hormuz in a chokehold due to Iran-U.S. hostilities, Oman has pitched investment opportunities to India in a new port that could provide uninterrupted access to energy resources from the Persian Gulf.

Speaking here on Wednesday, a high-level representative of the Sohar Port of Oman welcomed Indian investments into the port and said it would serve as a platform to connect businesses in regional and global markets.

“India represents an important and growing dimension of Sohar’s international investment landscape, with established Indian businesses already contributing to our



The Sohar Port is located on the Omani coast on the Gulf of Oman, far from the Strait of Hormuz. FILE PHOTO

industrial ecosystem. There is significant potential to deepen this relationship through investments that complement our industrial clusters, strengthen value chains and create new opportunities for growth,” said Raid Al Rubaiey, CEO of Sohar Freezone and Deputy CEO

of Sohar Port. The port is located on the Omani coast on the Gulf of Oman, and ships can access hubs in the Gulf through this port as it sits far from the Strait of Hormuz.

Mr. Rubaiey said that Sohar Port has received investments of over \$30 billion and that it is capable of

handling 72 million tonnes of cargo annually. “Sohar provides an established industrial and logistics platform connecting businesses to regional and global markets,” he said.

The remarks came at the end of a two-day promotional event organised by the Embassy of Oman, during which the Ambassador of Oman, Issa Saleh Al Shibani, introduced the port and the Freezone to Indian businesses, manufacturers and exporters to increase Indian participation in the port.

Earlier, Oman had offered Duqm and Salalah ports to India, but the Sohar Port has the advantage of being located in the northeast of Oman, close to vital energy pipelines of the United Arab Emirates and eastern Saudi Arabia.

Mahua says she faced eggs like ‘freedom fighters faced bullets’

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra on Wednesday alleged that BJP workers threw eggs at her during a visit to her Krishnanagar constituency in Nadia district of West Bengal.

In a series of posts on X, Ms. Moitra referred to an oral observation made by the Supreme Court last month, when it denied her permission to appear virtually before an investigating officer in a case over her allegedly provocative Facebook posts, on the apprehension that she might be attacked with eggs.

“Big shout out to Hon’ble Justice Dipankar Datta! MiLord - I came to my constituency for a mtng [meeting] informing @WBPolice



Mahua Moitra

EC calls both Trinamool factions for hearing today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission (EC) has called both factions of the Trinamool Congress – one led by former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and the other by Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee – for hearings again on Thursday.

The EC met both factions on Saturday over their claim on the party name and symbol. The poll body had sought additional documents from the Ritabrata faction. In separate letters dated September 16, the poll body asked the Ritabrata team to reach the EC headquarters in Delhi at 3 p.m. and the Mamata-led grouping at 4 p.m.

E-mail:- acezoneii@yahoo.com/acejipr.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

Additional Chief Engineer P.W.D. Zone-II, Jaipur
PWD Campus, Jacob Road, Jaipur
Phone :- 0141-2226537 Ex.:-299

File No. 1254 Date. 12/09/2026

Short Term NIT NO-27/2026-27

Bids for “Budget Announcement Year 2026-27, 06 Packages/ Road Works in Jaipur-Rural & Alwar District are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM on dated 23.09.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be seen on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state; and <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in>. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs 2765.25 lacs.

S. no	UBN	S. no	UBN
1	PWD2627WSOB11936	4	PWD2627WLOB11934
2	PWD2627WSOB11931	5	PWD2627WSOB11933
3	PWD2627WSOB11932	6	PWD2627WLOB11935

Adtl. Chief Engineer
PWD Zone-II Jaipur

DIPRC/16006/2026

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY - 754 142, ODISHA (INDIA)

MEDICAL DEPARTMENT
FILE NO. CMO/OEA/IGL/401/2026/1082, DATE: 11.09.2026

E-TENDER CALL NOTICE

E-tenders are invited on behalf of Paradip Port Authority for the work “Providing manpower for office work, Housekeeping and Para-medical Worker for PPA Hospital”.

The last date & time of submission of Dt.30.09.2026 on 17.00 Hrs.

For details, please refer website <http://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.

Chief Medical Officer,
Paradip Port Authority
PPA/PR/26/2026-2027, dt.15/09/2026

सी डैक Centre for Development
CDAC of Advanced Computing

Expression of Interest (Eoi)

C-DAC invites Expression of Interest (EOI) for “Selection of Industry partner for Development of CT Scanner.”

For details visit 'www.cdac.in',
Contact: 0471 2723333, 9847069184, tpc@cdac.in

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Short Tender Notice No. 50/2026-27/SE(W-East)/EE-East/DB/GV/MC/ Dt:15-09-2026

1. No. of Works	: 1 No
2. Value of works (ECV)	: Rs.117.84 Lakhs
3. Down loading Starting Date	: 15-09-2026 @ 02.00 P.M.
4. Down loading End Date	: 18-09-2026 @ 02.00 P.M.
5. Last date for Submission of bid	: 18-09-2026 @ 03.00 P.M.

Further details at <http://www.aeprocurement.gov.in>
O/o the Executive Engineer (PW-III) Division. **For Commissioner**

E-mail:- acetonk.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

Office Of The Additional Chief Engineer P.W.D. Zone-Tonk (Raj.)

Bambor Underpass New Housing Board Colony NH-52 Road
कमराक - 1437-1446 दिनांक :- 03.09.2026

NIB NO-04/2026-27

02 Nos. Bids for in SWM District are invited from interested bidders Dated 07-09-2026 to 21.09.2026 upto 6.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be seen on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state; and <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in>. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs.2391.53 Lacs.

NIB code **PWD2627A2629**
UBN is: **PWD2627WLOB11695**
UBN is: **PWD2627WLOB11696**
DIPRC/**P5813/2026**

(H.L. MEENA)
Adtl. Chief Engineer
PWD Zone-Tonk

APPOINTMENT

Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corporation Ltd.
(A Government of India Enterprise-Navratna)
South Central Zone - Secunderabad
CIN:L74899DL1999GOH01707

Walk-in Interview for Qualified Professionals

Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corporation Ltd (IRCTC Ltd), South Central Zone - Secunderabad intends to engage the services of qualified professionals on contract basis.

1. Hospitality Monitors 2.Tourism Monitors 3.CA/CMA
Further details viz, for eligibility criteria, walk-in interview date/venue and other terms & conditions of engagement visit: www.irctc.com.

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PHED CIRCLE NAGAU

No:- TA/2026-27/3789-3795 Date: 11.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID 13-14/2026-27

Bid for Commissioning work of HP/TW (Nit No 13-14/2026-27 and are invited from interested bidders upto 06.00 PM 24.09.2026 and 30.09.2026 other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; phedwater.rajasthan.gov.in departmental website.

NIT No.	SPPP UBN No
13/2026-27	PHE 2627 WSRC 05172
14/2026-27	PHE 2627 WSRC 05173

“SAVE WATER-SAVE LIFE”
(SHRAWAN SINGH KHIRIA)
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PHED CIRCLE NAGAU

DIPRC/15975/2026

GOVERNMENT OF PUDUCHERRY
PUDUCHERRY REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
Office of the Town and Country Planning Department

INVITATION FOR APPLICATION FOR APPOINTMENT OF MEMBERS IN PUDUCHERRY REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY

The Government of Puducherry as mandated under section 20 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 (No. 16 of 2016) hereby invites applications for appointment of two Members in Puducherry Real Estate Regulatory Authority (PRERA). Complete information on qualification, eligibility criteria, application format and other details may be obtained from the website of Puducherry Real Estate Regulatory Authority (<https://prera.py.gov.in>). Application in the prescribed format along with supporting documents should reach the office of Town and Country Planning Department (TCPD), Puducherry on or before 9th October, 2026 at 5.45 PM. (Note: Those who have already applied pursuant to 10.12.2023 & 10.06.2025 advertisement need not apply again and their applications will be considered subject only to their continuing to be eligible on the cutoff date vide this advertisement).

Chief Town Planner, TCPD-Cum- Nodal officer, PRERA
Jawahar Nagar, Boomianpet, Puducherry- 605 005

No:204/DIP/AD(Press)/2026-2027

कार्यालय अधीक्षा अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, वृत्त बारां

क्रमांक : 1767 दिनांक : 03/09/2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 14/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से बजट घोषणा संख्या 2025-26 में घोषित प्रति विधानसभा क्षेत्र 10.00 करोड़ के नीचे पेवेबल/मिशिन सिक सड़क 1 कार्य एवं बजट घोषणा संख्या 206/2026-27 में घोषित नौन पेवेबल/मिशिन सिक सड़क 4 कार्य (कुल 5 कार्य) हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एम्बू दूर संचार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि से संजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के एए श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रयत्र में ई-प्रोक्चुरमेंट प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साईट <http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। यू.पी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।

इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेब साईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड होना आवश्यक है।

NIB Code :- PWD 2627A2610
UBN No. :- 1- PWD2627WSOB11585, 2- PWD2627WSOB11586, 3- PWD2627WSOB11587
4- PWD2627WSOB11588, 5- PWD2627WSOB11591

DIPRC/15747/2026

अधीक्षा अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. वृत्त बारां

NATIONAL BOARD OF EXAMINATIONS IN MEDICAL SCIENCES
(Autonomous body of the M/o. Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
NAMS Building, Medical Enclave, Ansari Nagar
New Delhi – 110029

FOREIGN MEDICAL GRADUATE EXAMINATION (FMGE) – OCTOBER 2026

NOTICE

National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) shall conduct the **FMGE – OCTOBER 2026 on 31-10-2026.**

Applications are being invited from **11-09-2026 (05:00PM Onwards) to 25-09-2026 (Till 11:55 PM)** at NBEMS website:

<https://natboard.edu.in/viewnbexam?exam=fmge>

There is no other method for submitting the application other than the above online method. Applications submitted through any other medium will be summarily rejected.

Candidate Care Support: +91-7996165333	Helpline Portal on applicant login page • Communication Web Portal on NBEMS Website
--	---

The government has ordered cab aggregators to stop providing advance tipping options even before booking a ride, as the practice is misleading and unfair, Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare said on Wednesday. The secretary's comment comes a day after the Central Consumer Protection Authority slapped a ₹10 lakh penalty on ride-hailing platform Rapido for various unfair business practices. The authority is currently examining the business practices of Uber and Ola. Responding to queries related to taxi ride aggregators, Ms. Khare said the National Consumer Helpline has received a lot of complaints against them. PTI

For India, the progress towards gender parity stood at 64.5%, below the global average. While India's score improved slightly over the last year, its global ranking remained unchanged at 131st.

FAITH

Devotion of Gopikas

Srimad Bhagavatam explores the supreme devotion of the Gopikas towards Lord Krishna during the Rasa Leela, said Navalpakkam Sri Ramachar in a discourse. On a serene, moonlit autumn night, Lord Krishna decides to engage in divine pastimes with the Gopikas of Vrindavan. To gather them without sending formal messengers, He plays His divine flute. Upon hearing the sweet music, the Gopikas abandon their household chores, families, and sleeping infants, rushing out into the forest in utter haste. When they arrive, Lord Krishna tests their steadfastness by advising them to return home. They say their minds have been completely stolen by His flute song, making it impossible for them to return to worldly life.

Moved by their devotion, Krishna initially grants their wish and joins them in the Rasa Leela, but soon disappears to dissolve any subtle pride (*Ahankara*) within them. Devastated by His sudden separation, the Gopikas wander through the forests of Vrindavan. Unable to find Him, they gather on the banks of the Yamuna and sing the Gopika Geetham, expressing their intense longing and glorifying His divine nature. They glorify His lotus-like eyes and beg for His compassionate glance, making four heartfelt requests: that He place His reassuring lotus hands upon their heads, allow them to behold His smiling face, rest His holy feet – which walked the pastures and conquered Kaliya – upon their hearts, and grant them the nectar of His life-restoring words. Touched by their selfless love and poignant stanzas, Lord Krishna reappears before them. Overjoyed, the Gopikas welcome Him back in various loving ways, completely forgetting their grief.

Varun ruled out of Asian Games, Vipraj named as replacement



He bowls the same way whenever you bowl him: Aakash on Bumrah



Brook's unbeaten hundred sets up England's mammoth victory



Buttler overtakes Rohit to become second-highest T20I run-scorer



India aims for a series sweep, Afghans hope to script a win

I try to shut out the noise, says Samson

Nabi, Naman get ODI call-ups for WI series

WPL 2027
from Jan. 14
to Feb. 7

India beats Thailand but Arjun loses; women have it easy

An even contest in the offing on the hard-courts of Seoul

CM
YK

INBRIEF



Espi saves Real's blushes with late winner at Elche

Real Madrid substitute Carlos Espi snatched his team a last-gasp 3-2 win at Elche on Tuesday in LaLiga. The striker, who already saved his team at Espanyol in its opening game with a late strike, tucked home at the back post in the 91st minute after Real threw away a two-goal lead.

The results: Rayo Vallecano 2 (Garcia 3, Pedrosa 26) bt Espanyol 1 (Fernandez 54); Alaves 0 lost to Valencia 1 (Rioja 78); Elche 2 (Osorio 71, Nino 83) lost to Real Madrid 3 (Dituro 25-og, Mbappe 33, Espi 90+1).

ACT: Pakistan requests AHF to shift its matches from India

Pakistan on Wednesday asked the Asian Hockey Federation to shift its Asian Champions Trophy matches to a neutral venue, citing a “sensitive bilateral situation” with host India. The Pakistan Hockey Federation (PHF) said it wanted a neutral venue to ensure the country’s uninterrupted and full participation in the men’s Asian Champions Trophy. The ACT will be held in Mohali and Jalandhar from October 27 to November 5.



Argentina calls up Messi for farewell game against Benin

Lionel Messi was, on Tuesday, named in Argentina’s squad for a friendly against Benin on October 6, a match that will serve as his farewell appearance after announcing his international retirement last month.



Retired tennis great Nadal to play exhibition matches

Retired Spanish tennis great Rafael Nadal will return to the court in front of a crowd for the first time since his retirement in October to celebrate his academy’s 10th anniversary. Nadal will compete at his academy in his home town Manacor in Mallorca “in a series of exhibition matches together with big names from the sport”, said the academy in a statement.

James Rodriguez retires from Colombian national team

Colombian footballer James Rodriguez, one of the best players in the country’s history, on Tuesday announced his retirement from the national team after 15 years and three World Cups. “I’m leaving with serenity because I know I gave absolutely everything,” the 35-year-old captain said in a social media video, his eyes welling with tears.



PTF president Qureshi to play doubles at the Asian Games

Pakistan Tennis Federation (PTF) president Aisam ul Haq Qureshi will compete as a doubles player in the upcoming Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya. The 46-year-old Qureshi, a former US Open men’s doubles finalist with India’s Rohan Bopanna, confirmed on Wednesday that he had decided to play in the men’s doubles event for Pakistan.

Greater emphasis on cultural sensitivity as Indian athletes arrive in Japan

The host nation is very strict in terms of how you behave, how you dress and how you manage your waste: Deputy Chef de Mission Sharath Kamal

ASIAN GAMES

Jonathan Selvaraj
NEW DELHI

Don’t litter. Carry your trash until you find a bin. Cover visible tattoos. Queue properly. Use earphones, avoid loud music in public, and do not hug or touch strangers.

As India’s athletes arrive in Nagoya for the Asian Games, they have been briefed on Japanese etiquette. “You are not just travelling to Japan as an athlete; you are representing India. Respect the rules, respect the people, respect the culture,” says a Sports Authority of India video shared with participants.

Deputy *Chef de Mission* and table tennis great



New digs: A view of the container-based housing units for athletes in Nagoya. REUTERS

Achanta Sharath Kamal says greater emphasis has been placed on cultural sensitivity this time.

“Japan is very, very

strict in terms of how you behave, how you dress and how you manage your waste. There are very few dustbins, but you can’t lit-

ter anywhere. You need to carry the trash back to where the dustbin is,” Sharath told *Sportstar*. Athletes have also been

sensitised about sexual harassment and abuse. “There’s no excuse for it. You can’t touch anybody for any reason,” he said.

Preparation has extended to accommodation. Some athletes will stay in shipping containers and cruise ships, with prototypes set up at national training centres in Bengaluru, Patiala and elsewhere so athletes could experience the limited space beforehand.

Sharath, who has travelled three times to Nagoya in the build-up, says conditions have changed sharply since his first visit last year.

“Last year it was 40 degrees and clear skies. This year there have been typhoons... there was flooding a few days back.”

The Games will also be logistically challenging.

Unlike Hangzhou, where events were largely centralised, Nagoya’s venues and accommodation are spread across a wide area. Hockey, for instance, will be based near its venue, around 90 minutes from the repurposed Games village.

India has consequently decentralised medical support, with doctors and physiotherapists across locations. It has also pushed for consistent food options, including halal meals and comfort food such as plain *daal*, and mapped Indian restaurants near athletes’ hotels.

The organisers initially planned four athletes per 12-by-18-foot container but reduced that to two after objections from India and other countries. Boxing weigh-ins have also been moved to the team hotel.

Vijender expects India to win five or six medals at Asian Games

BOXING

Y.B. Sarangi

World and Olympic medalist Vijender Singh has advised the Asian Games-bound Indian boxers to cut out all distractions, including mobile phones, and focus on winning medals.

“I told them, don’t distract your mind with that phone or media or anything. Just focus. It’s a war. You should win the war. After that, do whatever you want to do,” said Vijender, a 2008 Olympic bronze medallist in middleweight, in a virtual interaction. He expected Indian boxers to win five to six medals.

“Sakshi (Choudhary, 51kg) is hard-working. Preeti Pawar (54kg) is doing well. Priya Ghanghas (60kg) will also perform well. And Lovlina (Borgohain, 75kg).

The girls are more hungry for medals. Among boys, Sachin (Siwach, 60kg) is good. And (Narendar) Berwal (+90kg). He got an Asian Games medal and Arjuna Award. He must be confident.

“But I feel the girls will perform better. Most of them are from Haryana. In the news, people say Haryanvi people don’t like girls. But our girls (are) changing everything.”



Sakshi. FILE PHOTO

Vijender, who bagged a bronze and a gold in the 2006 and 2010 Asian Games respectively, shared how he made light of a dislocated left thumb to upset World champion Abbas Atoev in the Guangzhou Asiad final to secure gold.

Harboursing a competitive mindset, Vijender asked the Indians to ignore the concerns emerging from Japan.

“It doesn’t matter if the room is big or small. What matters is our performance. We aren’t going there to have fun. We are going there to fight. And we have to win that fight.

“Countries like Kazakhstan, Uzbekistan, China and Japan are doing well. The Asian Games will be tough but our boxers are in good shape. I hope they will do well,” he said.

(Watch Asian Games live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV).

How coach Adhiban went from fast to feast

CHESS

P.K. Ajith Kumar

One of the most memorable moments of the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, which concluded in Bengaluru on Sunday, came after the match between Ganges Grandmasters and Cheq Mumba Masters, earlier.

The Grandmasters won the match, the best player of which was Stavroula Tsolakidou.

The Greek player, however, handed over the trophy to the Grandmasters’ coach, B. Adhiban, making his debut in such a role. She said he deserved it more.

Adhiban graciously accepted the trophy from her on the stage. He revealed he had indeed helped Tso-



Good catch: Adhiban said he was glad the team got Aronian, in pic, and Nepomniachtchi as the two main players. P.K. AJITH KUMAR

lakidou with her preparation and suggested the openings for her various opponents.

“She is an excellent student and has excellent memory,” Adhiban told *The Hindu*. “I was happy to work with her and see that we were getting the results right through the GCL.”

Tsolakidou went on to win the Player-of-the-Tour-

nament award. She, in fact, was a revelation.

“People, including some of our teammates did not expect her to do so well,” said Adhiban, who was part of the bronze-medal winning Indian teams at the Olympiad in 2014 and 2022. “Our other female player, Polina Shuvalova was also brilliant, but I wasn’t surprised by her, as

she is very good in these fast time controls.”

He feels the Grandmasters team was just perfect, though there was uncertainty going into the auction. A new management had taken over, and he joined only shortly before the auction. “I was glad that we could get Levon Aronian and Ian Nepomniachtchi as our two main players,” said the Chennai-based Grandmaster. “Leinier Dominguez Perez and Leon Mendonca also delivered for us.”

Adhiban contributed in another way. After the early disappointments, he decided to fast – skipping breakfast and lunch – and to have dinner only if his team won. The players weren’t aware of that.

But, they played so well that Adhiban could have his dinner, after all.

‘The environment of a multi-sport event is something the team is looking forward to’

CRICKET

Press Trust of India
TOKYO

The Indian women’s cricket team head coach Amol Muzumdar said his players are eagerly looking forward to the unique atmosphere of the Asian Games after the defending

champion landed in Japan determined to extend its recent run of success.

“The team is looking forward to the Asian Games and enjoying the environment of the multi-sport event,” Muzumdar said after arriving here with members of his support staff.

A few members of the squad travelled with the

coaching staff, while the rest were scheduled to arrive later in the day, with pacer Kranti Gaud and spinner Shree Charani among those to land with the coaching staff.

Muzumdar said the experience of living alongside athletes from different sports, sharing the Games Village and competing on a multi-sport stage is so-

omething he wants his players to embrace.

“The environment of a multi-sport event is something the team is looking forward to. We want the players to enjoy that experience as well.”

India begins its Asian Games campaign with a quarterfinal game against hosts Japan on September 18 at Nisshin.

Asiad boxing medallists will directly book berths in Worlds

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

The Asian Games 2026 medallists will directly book their berths in next year’s World boxing championships, which will be the first qualifying event for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, the Boxing Federation of India (BFI) said on Wednesday.

“We have tried to make the selection policy comprehensive and fair so that no good boxer is left out,” said a BFI official.

“Asian Games medallists will be selected as the main entries in their respective weight categories. The gold medallists of the 10th National championships shall serve as reserve entries in those weight categories,” said the BFI circu-

lar. The 10th National championships will be held in Guwahati (women) and Patna (men) in December.

For weight categories in which India does not win medals at the Asian Games and the LA 2028 weight categories that are not part of the Asiad (men’s 65kg and women’s 57kg and 70kg), the gold medallists of the above-mentioned Nationals will be selected as main entries.

The Asian qualifier in China next year and two World qualifying tournaments in 2028 will also provide quota places for LA28.

Indian boxers losing in the ‘quota bout round’ (the winner of which earns a quota place) at the World championships will get direct entry to the Asian

qualifiers. The remaining slots will be filled through a ranking selection trial among elite National campers after the boxers enter the National camp through dedicated pathways.

A similar process will be followed for the two World qualifying tournaments, to be held in Italy and Hungary, in 2028.

The National camp will start with medallists of the 10th National championships, Asian Games medallists and wild cards to be selected by the BFI selection committee.

For non-Olympic weights, gold medallists of the Nationals will be the main entries for the World championships in Kazakhstan, while the silver medallists will be the reserves.

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R. Kaushik

One of the hallmarks of a champion outfit is the propensity to eke out match-turning performances from different quarters and not depend on just one or two individuals to carry the day. India are nothing if not a champion outfit, their 20-over June misadventures in Ireland and England notwithstanding. There is a reason why they have won the last two T20 World Cups, there is a reason why they have been able to tide over potentially crippling loss of personnel through injuries and still put out formidable, fighting fit units.

India have numerous fallback options for almost every position when it comes to the T20 format, specifically. Especially from a batting standpoint, there is so much depth and quality and choices that it is inevitable that many who might have walked into any other side are not even on the fringes of consideration for selection. Why, India didn't think twice before giving Suryakumar Yadav the heave-ho immediately after the Mumbaikar masterminded a successful defence of the World Cup, and that too on home soil - neither feat accomplished previously. His middling to ordinary form overshadowed his leadership and man-management chops as preparations for the next World Cup began immediately after the trophy was lifted in Ahmedabad in March.

For the longest time, Suryakumar was ranked the No. 1 T20I batter globally and even though his form slumped dramatically in his last 15 months in charge, he still has plenty of cricket left in him. Yet, to sever ties ruthlessly pointed to prudence over sentiment, never mind if it wasn't a popular call or, to many, even an immediately warranted one.

While there are deserving and excellent alternatives for most roles within the Indian cricketing landscape, the one most coveted for obvious reasons is a fast-bowling all-rounder. So many countries take that spot for granted, almost. Even today, Australia have Mitchell Marsh (who doesn't bowl so much these days) and Marcus Stoinis, not to mention Cameron Green and Beau Webster. England have a long list, as do South Africa who, since their return from isolation, have thrown up numerous such luminaries. West Indies too can dip into that giving bag while New Zealand have a generous assortment to select from.

India, though, haven't always been blessed with an overflowing cup when it comes to this specific requirement. There have been all-rounders of various degrees of proficiency in the post-Kapil Dev era, with Irfan Pathan perhaps being the most successful of the lot. It was a given that Kapil was irreplaceable; the Haryana Hurricane was a generational genius and any quest to unearth a like-for-like substitute was always going to be an exercise in futility. As India meandered from one alternative to another, they stumbled upon Hardik Pandya, a natural athlete who could crank up the pace, who struck the ball a mile and who was an electric fielder.

Pandya slammed a century and snared a five-wicket in his brief Test career - 11 Tests in 13 months between July 2017 and August 2018 - but taking a cue from his complaining body, decided that the longer version was not his cup of tea. It wasn't that the spirit wasn't willing, but his body couldn't take the load of Test cricket. India would have loved for Pandya to keep continuing to play the five-day game but instead were happy to settle for his services in the two white-ball versions, though even there, he has been compelled to miss increasingly more matches in the last couple of years as he sidles towards his mid-30s.

The closest India now have to a Pandya sub is Nitish Kumar, himself no stranger to injuries though he is only 23 and has been an international for exactly as many months. Nitish's appearances for the country across the three formats has been restricted to a mere 22 games - 10 in Tests and six apiece in ODIs and T20Is, not so much because he has been considered superfluous to requirement as owing to the fact that he has often been unavailable for selection.

This ongoing Afghanistan series marks another comeback from the infirmary for the young man from the port city of Visakhapatnam. In June, he picked up a quadriceps injury that kept him away from the twin tours of Ireland and England, and the subsequent three-match sojourn in Zimbabwe. The quadriceps problem is the latest in an already long and burgeoning list of injuries - hernia (June 2024), side strain (January 2025), knee (July 2025), neck spasms (October 2025) and quadriceps (also October 2025).

Around all this, in his desire to become the 'best all-rounder' (his words), Nitish embarked on a mission to ramp up his pace, ahead of IPL 2026. After watching *Instagram* videos on biomechanics and fast bowling, he got in touch with protagonist Steffan Jones, the Englishman who plied his fast-bowling wares on the county circuit for 20 years and played three years of professional rugby too. An unforgiving one-week crash course ahead of the tournament helped Nitish add a staggering 10 kilometres per hour to his



Tight-rope walk with a coveted resource

The soft-spoken young man with a ready smile is currently back in business again, and hopefully this time, it won't be just another cameo appearance

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Nitish's inconsistencies, especially with the ball, can be easily explained away simply because he is still reasonably inexperienced, with less than 1,000 overs under his belt in representative cricket. Internationally, he has bowled a little over 125 overs (for 16 wickets)

bowling as he went from late 120s to 140 occasionally, but whether that has come at a cost remains to be seen.

Nitish's career, still in its infancy, is already a tale of what might be. Every performance of promise has been followed by a trough, either through loss of form or because of the unwelcome injury malady. When he made a spectacular breakthrough hundred in the Boxing Day Test at the MCG in December 2024, Nitish seemed to have made himself undroppable, but for various reasons, he has only played six subsequent Tests. Among them was the third of five Tests against England at Lord's last year, when he picked up two quick wickets to stymie a blazing start by the hosts, but he was forced to miss the rest of the series with a knee injury.

The soft-spoken young man with a ready smile is currently back in business again, and hopefully this time, it won't be another cameo appearance. As if to reiterate the value he brings to the side, Nitish walked away with the Player of the Match award in the second T20I against Afghanistan on Tuesday for his three for

24 from three good overs. A wicket with the first delivery of each of his three overs did the trick as the Afghans failed to touch 160 for the second time in three nights, allowing India to breeze home on the back of the pyrotechnics of openers Sanju Samson and Abhishek Sharma. Abhishek was the Player of the Match in the big win in the series-opener, showing that India boast match-winners aplenty at both ends of the spectrum.

Scope for improvement

Nitish's inconsistencies, especially with the ball, can be easily explained away simply because he is still reasonably inexperienced, with less than 1,000 overs under his belt in representative cricket. Internationally, he has bowled a little over 125 overs (for 16 wickets) and it might appear a stretch to label him an all-rounder immediately, but while he may not be able to influence - yet - the course of a match with his bowling alone, one can state with confidence that he will be a force to reckon with with the ball too once he manages to keep himself free from injuries.

Nitish's immediate aim will be to steer clear of injuries for at least the next two and a half months, build up a decent volume of bowling work - at the very minimum - and remain in the fray for selection for the two Test matches in New Zealand in November. There are a host of white-ball internationals between now and November 19, when the first Test gets underway at Wellington's Basin Reserve, for Nitish to achieve that goal, starting with Thursday's final T20I in New Delhi. He has been withdrawn from the Asian

Games where India will kick off their gold medal defence in the quarterfinals on September 28. Instead, he will figure in three ODIs followed by five T20Is at home against West Indies, and as many such contests in New Zealand that will segue into five further ODIs before the Test series begins.

At No. 8, where he will most likely slot in should he be available, Nitish will offer the balance India so desperately crave away from the subcontinent. It was from that position that he uncorked a fabulous hundred against the Aussies, which means there is batting depth as well as an additional pace bowling choice which is so essential on what are certain to be seaming surfaces in New Zealand. Nitish's presence will allow Shubman Gill to go into with three frontline quicks and still have five proper bowling options - Ravindra Jadeja should provide variety and experience with his left-arm spin - which is such an essential requirement in the quest for 20 wickets that could translate into victory and 12 World Test Championship points.

The recent prolificacy of the Indian top order hasn't allowed Nitish to have a bat internationally since January, and maybe there is a case for him to be pushed up the order from time to time so that he has competitive game-time in that discipline as well. As those who have played the game at any level - and even those who haven't - have pointed out repeatedly, there is no substitute for time in the middle. No number of balls hit at nets will replicate the intensity of a match scenario and India wouldn't want Nitish to go in cold from a batting standpoint when the Test matches come around with so much hinging on the outcome. That's where Gill and head coach Gautam Gambhir will have to walk the tricky tightrope of balancing the immediate (results) with the immediate future (match readiness).

India have been forced to approach several fixtures in the recent past with the full complement never available for selection. Some of the 'offenders' in the injury list fall in the 'serial' category - Jasprit Bumrah, Pandya (who hasn't represented the country since March), Harshit Rana, Washington Sundar and Nitish.

Despite the depth that speaks to the vibrancy of Indian cricket, this is far from an ideal scenario. Gill, the Test and ODI boss, and T20I captain Shreyas Iyer, will be desperate for the luxury of picking from the complete riches. Nitish might not be on top of the 'riches' section, but he is a much-coveted resource whose progress over the next 75 days will be followed with interest. And optimism.

THE GIST

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India has a research blindspot: its own science system

The country needs to invest in metascience, in institutions, expertise, and people whose job is to study how Indian science actually works; it means documenting what has worked and what has not, instead of forgetting it with every change in leadership

Moumita Koley

The U.S. Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) recently released a 125-page policy document titled ‘Science: A New Golden Age’, which presents a renewed vision for American science. It positions itself as a sequel to the American inventor Vannevar Bush’s 1945 report, ‘Science: The Endless Frontier’, which laid the foundations of the famously successful post-war American research system.

As it happens, the new report can be consequential for the Indian science system as well – by revealing the importance of something that India currently does not have but should as quickly as possible: the ability to study its own science system with evidence.

Why a system works

The report starts with a diagnosis well known to the science-of-science, or metascience, research community: despite sustained increases in research and development investment, returns in scientific productivity and innovation have not kept pace. But more than agreement or disagreement with this diagnosis, what matters is that a system should be able to interrogate itself using its own data and be able to reach a conclusion like this.

After its diagnosis, the report draws two conclusions worth exploring. First, it says the U.S. should invest more in individual researchers with bold, high-risk ideas rather than routing funds primarily through what it calls “legacy institutions”. Second, it calls into question the prevailing one-size-fits-all model of research funding, instead advocating for experimenting with alternative funding mechanisms. It also calls for funding agencies to evaluate whether their own mechanisms can be made more effective.

The institutions that fund science should be accountable for the evidence that what they fund and why are actually working – and not just in the U.S. Across Europe, the U.K., China, and Japan, governments and funders are investing seriously in metascience that is able to address this concern. Governments and the people need concrete answers to how their research systems actually function: specifically, how it sets funding priorities, how funding mechanisms perform, how peer-review behaves, how it assesses researchers, how its incentives affect the way scientists collaborate, and so on.

Building a memory

In India, this conversation has barely begun. The country’s science system has historically been shaped by the experience, judgment, and leadership of eminent scientists. That experience is invaluable and must remain a source of evidence – but it is also no longer sufficient considering today’s research ecosystem is far more complex than it was half a century ago, and



The institutions that fund science should be accountable for the evidence that what they fund, and why, are actually working. GETTY IMAGES

understanding it requires systematic analysis. Specifically, it needs to draw on economics, the sociology of science, political science, public policy, organisational studies, scientometrics, and history and philosophy.

An exploration of bibliographic databases shows that, between 1950 and 2024, Indian publications addressing metascience or closely related questions across these domains remained low. Except for scientometrics, Indian research in these areas accounted for only around 1-2% of global research output, with the total number of publications generally not exceeding a hundred over the entire period.

A related problem is institutional memory. As leadership and personnel change, experiential knowledge about what worked, what failed, and why is lost. India has very few publicly available analytical reports documenting the evolution of its research system, and little that carries institutional learning across successive generations of policymakers. Building that memory is itself part of building better science governance, and it is where metascience can have a significant impact.

For these reasons, India needs to invest in scientific research as well as in the capacity to study the ecosystem in which this research happens.

Reason of state

The OSTP report also called for setting clearer national scientific goals to streamline research efforts and speed up the translation of discoveries into technologies, including those for society’s benefit. This, too, is worth taking seriously but also debating carefully because it understates how much of

transformative science begins without any defined mission at all, i.e. as curiosity-driven research. And this, again, is precisely the kind of question a meaningful metascience capacity would allow India to debate with evidence rather than insights alone.

Quantum mechanics emerged in the early 20th century to answer fundamental questions about the nature of matter. It later became the foundation of semiconductors, lasers, and modern computing. Decades of curiosity-driven research in molecular biology, with no application in sight, eventually made CRISPR gene-editing and mRNA vaccines possible. The mathematics underlying today’s artificial intelligence – including neural networks and transformer architectures – emerged from exploratory research in statistical mechanics.

The economist Mariana Mazzucato has documented this pattern in her work on what she calls “the entrepreneurial state”. She has shown that many of the technologies in a single iPhone, including the internet, GPS, touchscreen, and the voice-recognition algorithms behind Siri, have their roots in blue-sky research funded by U.S. federal agencies such as DARPA and the National Institutes of Health. All these were undertaken decades before any company saw commercial application potential in them. In her account, the state was a bold and patient investor that was absorbing risks no private venture would touch. This is the kind of long-horizon, curiosity-driven investment that a purely ‘mission and metrics’ approach to funding – like what increasingly prevails in India today – risks crowding out. But at the same time, mission-oriented research has its own record of delivery. The Apollo programme

forced rapid advances in aerospace engineering, materials science, and computing that spread far beyond the space race. The Human Genome Project turned biology into a coordinated, global, infrastructure-scale enterprise. India itself had the Green Revolution, where crop-breeding research backed by state investment and clear food-security goals transformed the country’s relationship with hunger within a single generation. The Revolution has its own legitimate critics as well, regarding ecological costs, regional inequity, and long-term sustainability. But that very disagreement also makes the case for India to be able to evaluate a mission using evidence.

Striking the balance

A healthy research ecosystem may well need both approaches to research, with research on a mission being used to meet pressing challenges and curiosity-driven, blue-sky research to open new frontiers. It is just that any decision on where to strike that balance should rest on deliberation and evidence, rather than on which topics happen to be fashionable in global policy discourse at a given moment.

To facilitate that, India needs to invest in metascience, in institutions, expertise, and people whose job is to study how Indian science actually works. It means documenting what has worked and what has not, instead of forgetting it with every change in leadership, and building institutions strong enough to imagine an ambitious future for Indian science.

(Moumita Koley is a senior research analyst at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. moumita.chem@gmail.com)

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Scientific problems featuring cities

Vasudevan Mukunth

- QUESTION 1**
- The X paradox refers to a game where people get double the payout when a coin lands heads — yet people tend to pay only a small amount to play. The Swiss mathematician Nicolas Bernoulli used this paradox to challenge expected-value theory. Name X.
- QUESTION 2**
- In this game, there are three pegs and discs of increasing size stacked on one peg (with the smallest on top). The goal is to move the whole stack to another peg, one disc at a time, while never placing a larger disc on a smaller one. The game originated in 1883. Name it.
- QUESTION 3**
- The U.S. economist _____ once asked: if you must meet a stranger in New York City tomorrow, with no

- way to communicate, where and when would you go? The economist used the question to show how people participating in coordination games are often guided by shared cultural expectations. Fill in the blanks.
- QUESTION 4**
- In 1692, the Italian mathematician Vincenzo Viviani put forth a challenge: cut four equal windows into a hemispherical dome so that the remaining curved surface can be exactly squared, meaning its area can be expressed without using π . This, called the _____ problem, was an important result in geometry. Fill in the blank.
- QUESTION 5**
- Can you double the volume of a cube using only a compass and a ruler? This is one of the classic construction problems, named for the Greek city of Z, which is also the birthplace of Apollo in Greek mythology. Nineteenth century mathematicians proved this is impossible to do. Name Z.

- Answers to September 10 quiz:**
1. Continent hosting vast majority of world’s glacial ice – **Ans: Antarctica**
2. Warm continent that last had glaciers 19,000 years ago – **Ans:**

- Australia**
3. Glacier that is site of world’s highest altitude battlefield – **Ans: Siachen**
4. Substance that is mostly locked away in glaciers, ice sheets – **Ans: Freshwater**

5. Country with the most glaciers outside polar regions – **Ans: Pakistan**
- First contact:**
- K.N. Viswanathan | Mansi Rathod | Athul K. | Harsh Kumar | Muhammed Rafid



Visual: Name this city. Its name is part of a famous problem involving seven bridges — one of which is visible to the right here — that Leonhard Euler solved in 1736. GUMEROV ILDAR/PUBLIC DOMAIN



Space agencies are targeting the moon’s south pole region, where permanently shadowed craters are supposed to hold large quantities of water ice. GETTY IMAGES

Cities on the moon may run dry far faster than space barons think

Vasudevan Mukunth

As NASA and China speed up their lunar space programmes, a more-than-temporary human settlement on the moon inches closer to reality. Space agencies with these plans are targeting the moon’s south pole region, where permanently shadowed craters are supposed to hold large quantities of water ice.

In the long-term, entrepreneurs like Jeff Bezos have argued for moving heavy industries to the moon while Elon Musk has said the satellite can support a “self-growing city”. As on the earth, water is at the centre of these plans.

But a new study by two astronomers, Martin Elvis of the Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory and Jonathan McDowell of Durham University, has thrown up a reality check. The duo has estimated that even if the moon hosted one billion tonnes of water, it would support a population of only one million people for roughly a century if they recycled 98% of it.

The findings were published in *Frontiers in Space Technologies*. The scientists arrived at this estimate based on calculations of how much water the moon may really hold, how much electricity people and industrial activities consume, how much water a human settlement might need, and how efficiently that water can be reused.

Right now, the exact quantity of water on the moon is a major source of uncertainty, and which scientists are studying using robotic missions like India’s Chandrayaan and China’s Chang’e programmes. One 2022 study of 65 large permanently shadowed craters estimated that eight of them together hold around 34 million tonnes of water.

Against this backdrop, Elvis and McDowell assumed 1 billion tonnes of water as a generous baseline – around 4 lakh Olympic-sized swimming pools – and the demand to amount to 500 tonnes per person per year.

(The duo also estimated that a city of one million inhabitants would require around 2 GW of power, which can be sourced relatively easily from solar panels and nuclear reactors.)

Without recycling, this will sustain a million people for only around two years. But with 98% recycling, they estimated that a million people will deplete a billion tonnes of water in a century, and a lakh people in a millennium.

They also found one million people could have water for a millennium if they recycled the water to the tune of 99.75% – essentially living like the fictitious Fremmen tribe in the ‘Dune’ books and films.

At present, NASA has said it will set up a permanent outpost near the moon’s south pole from the 2030s under its ‘Moon Base’ programme. China’s ‘International Lunar Research Station’ plans for a basic station by 2035 that will be built out in the 2040s.

India itself is planning a crewed landing on the moon by 2040. In August, NASA also invited the Indian Space Research Organisation to participate in the ‘Moon Base’.

Since Elvis and McDowell assumed a minimum population of one lakh for their analysis, the findings don’t apply to short-duration missions or small lunar outposts. But as these outposts expand, the study suggests, the space agencies and the governments behind them may have to treat water on the moon as a strategic resource.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’